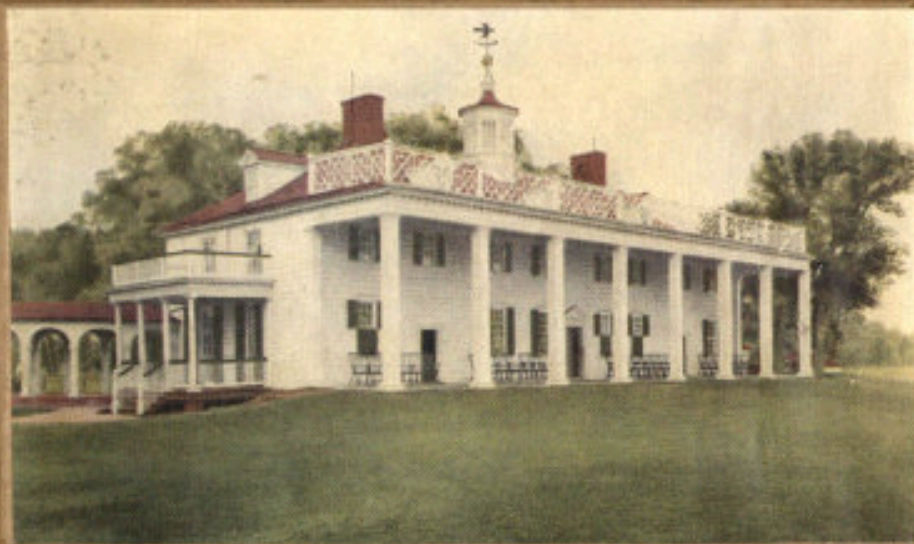




Mount Vernon

Virginia





Mount Vernon

Virginia



The Project Gutenberg eBook of An Illustrated Handbook of Mount Vernon, the Home of Washington

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Title: An Illustrated Handbook of Mount Vernon, the Home of Washington

Author: Mount Vernon Ladies' Association of the Union

Release date: November 19, 2017 [eBook #55997]

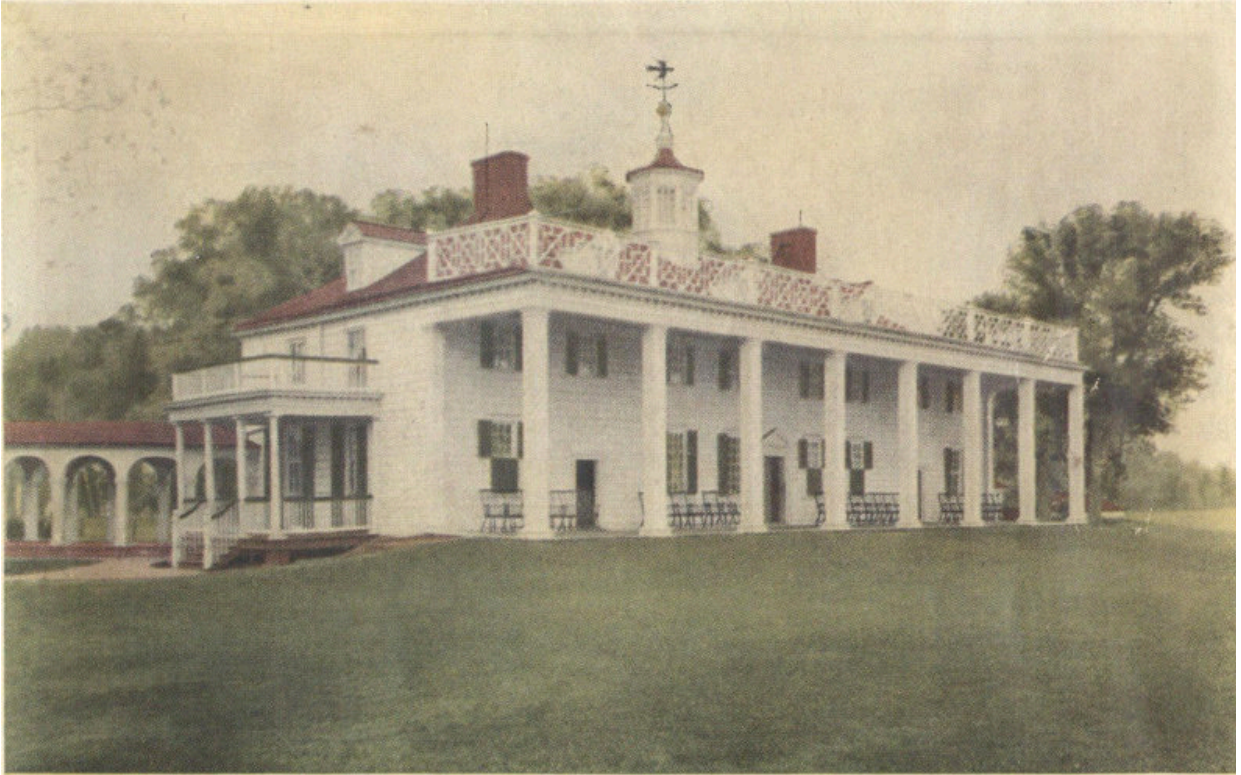
Most recently updated: October 23, 2024

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/55997

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AN
ILLUSTRATED HANDBOOK OF MOUNT VERNON, THE HOME OF
WASHINGTON ***



Mount Vernon, the Home of George Washington

***Purchased (in 1858), restored and maintained by the
Mt. Vernon Ladies' Association of the Union***



***Houdon's Bust of Washington
Made at Mount Vernon, 1785***

Copyright, 1928, by the
Mount Vernon Ladies' Association



Portrait of George Washington

By Chas. Wilson Peale

Bequeathed to the Mount Vernon Ladies' Association by the late Miss Jane Boudinot, in whose family's possession the portrait has been since 1788, when it was painted (from life) for Elias Boudinot

***An Illustrated Handbook of Mount
Vernon***

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<u>The Regents and Vice-Regents of the Mount Vernon Ladies' Association of the Union</u>	

The Home of Washington

In the year 1674, by Grant of Lord Culpeper, a tract of 5,000 acres situated on the west bank of the Potomac River, fifteen miles south of the present city of Washington, became the property of John Washington and Nicholas Spencer. Half of this tract, or 2,500 acres, descended to Lawrence Washington, who, in 1743, built a residence, and named the estate Mount Vernon, after the British Admiral under whom he had served. At Lawrence Washington's death (1752) the estate passed to the ownership of his half brother, George Washington, who subsequently extended the boundaries of his plantation until they included nearly 8,000 acres.

In 1799, when George Washington died, the property passed as a life interest to his widow, by whose will most of the household effects in the Mansion were, after her death, divided among her four grandchildren. Thus was the original furniture of Mount Vernon eventually scattered.

Bushrod Washington, John Augustine Washington, and John A. Washington, Jr., followed in succession as owners of Mount Vernon.

These gentlemen furnished the Mansion according to their individual tastes and made such minor changes as papering or painting the interior to preserve it.

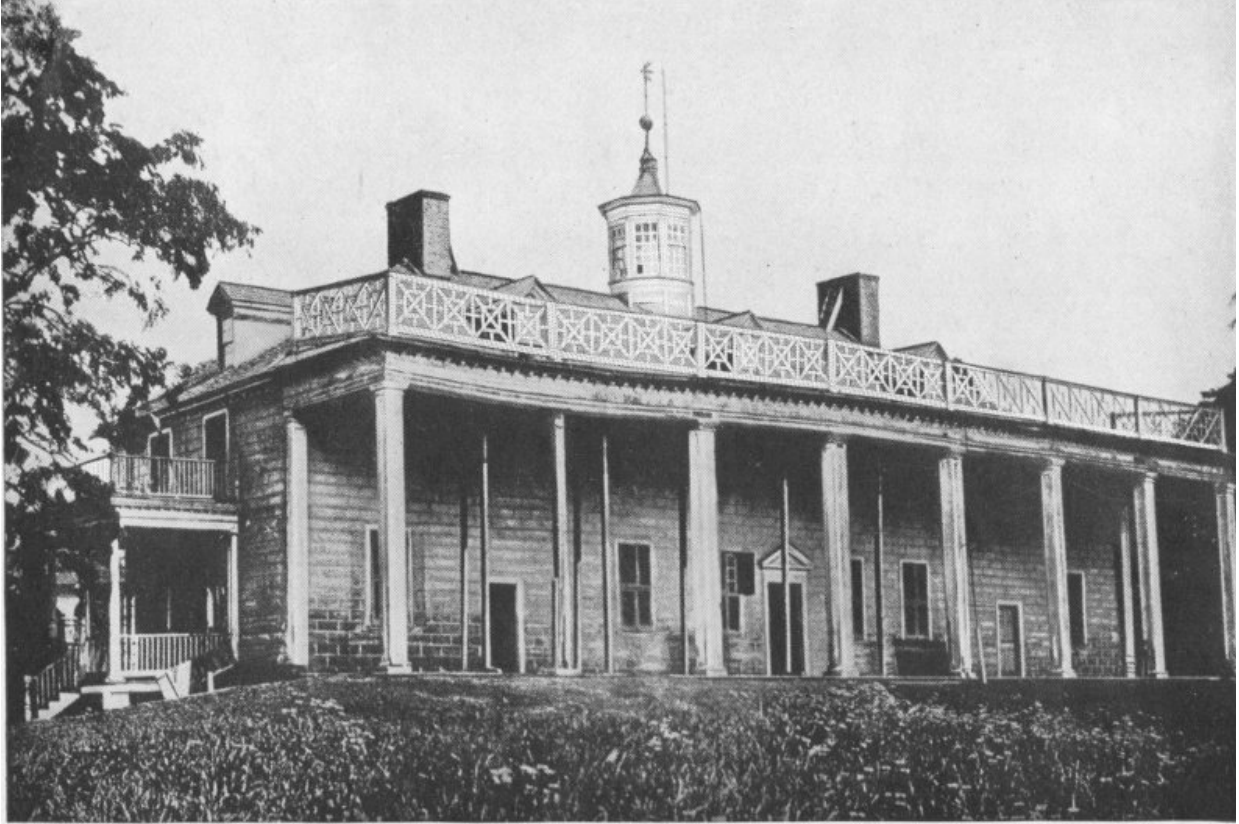
Mr. John A. Washington, Jr., the last-named owner, in accordance with the wishes of his family, to effect a permanent preservation of the property, offered to sell it to the National Government. This project failed, as did likewise an attempt to sell to the Commonwealth of Virginia.

At this juncture the Mount Vernon Ladies' Association of the Union was (in 1856) organized by Miss Pamela Cunningham, of South Carolina. Her appeal to the patriotism of all American women (December, 1853) resulted in the accomplishment of her noble project in spite of many obstacles. The purchase money was raised by contributions from thirty-three States of the

Union, materially aided by Hon. Edward Everett, of Massachusetts, in lecturing for the benefit of the Mount Vernon Fund, his contributions amounting to \$68,294.59. In 1858, this Association was thus enabled to buy from Mr. John A. Washington, Jr., and his heirs, 202 acres of the Mount Vernon estate, including the Tomb, the Mansion, attendant buildings, the wharf, etc., the price paid being \$200,000 and interest. 4

In 1887, an important addition of 33½ acres was achieved through the generosity of the late Mr. Jay Gould, of New York; in 1893 Mr. Christian Heurich, of Washington, D. C., gave three acres, and in 1925 Mr. and Mrs. Hugh McK. Landon, of Indianapolis, kindly donated about 23 acres more, thus making the total area owned by the Mt. Vernon Ladies' Association approximately 260 acres.

Among the many who visit Mount Vernon few are aware of what an expensive undertaking is involved in its restoration and preservation, nor do they realize on entering its gates that they, too, contribute their mite toward the maintenance of this historic place. To retain the appearance of that simplicity which characterized the home life of Washington, to preserve the reverence of his hallowed shrine and at the same time meet the protective requirements incident to increasing wear and tear, has been a problem to be mastered.



Mt. Vernon when purchased by the Mt. Vernon Ladies' Association of the Union

While the employment of modern appliances has become a necessity, they are masked as much as possible to avoid glaring contrast with the more primitive methods of olden times. For instance: to guard against accidents by fire all former and dangerous means of heating the buildings have given place to a hot water system, the mains of which pass through [5] subterranean conduits from a distant (underground) boiler room, and all buildings are lighted by a system of low voltage electricity installed under the direction of Mr. Edison.

Fire engines—both chemical and steam—are at hand for instant use, and guards are on constant watch both day and night. Powerful modern pumps (electrically driven) supply water from an artesian well for household purposes, and keep the emergency reservoirs filled. Sanitary drainage is an essential improvement. Bogs and swamps have been reclaimed to make the place more healthful.

Threatening landslides near the Mansion and old Tomb were averted by the costly expedient of tunneling the hill to drain the water-bearing sands, the source of disastrous surface movements which had caused Washington much alarm.

The Association owes to the interest and patriotism of Prof. Charles Sprague Sargent, of Arnold Arboretum, the replacement and listing of many trees planted at Mount Vernon during Washington's lifetime. A plan with the position of all historic trees is shown in the guide book. Successful efforts have been made to replant both the grounds of the Mansion and the surrounding woods according to Washington's original idea as expressed in his diary.

The repair and safeguarding of buildings and their contents, attention to the old trees Washington loved, his roads, walks, gardens and grounds, continually tax the energy and resources of the Association. That the steadfast aim and purpose, thus successfully achieved, is appreciated by those who are familiar with it, is admirably expressed in the concluding chapter of Owen Wister's "Seven Ages of Washington." The following is a brief quotation:

"Everything, every subject, every corner and step, seems to bring him close. It is an exquisite and friendly serenity which bathes one's sense, that seems to be charged all through with some meaning or message of beneficence and reassurance, but nothing that could be put in words. Turn into his garden and look at the walls and walks he planned, the box hedges, the trees, the flower beds, the great order and the great sweetness everywhere. You may spend an hour, you may spend a day, wandering, sitting, feeling this gentle power of the place; you may come back another time, it meets you, you cannot dispel it by familiarity. And as you think of this you bless the devotion of those whose piety and care treasure the place and keep it sacred and beautiful."



Unless otherwise designated all the tailpieces in this book represent original furnishings in use at Mount Vernon during the lifetime of General Washington.”

Entrance Gateway

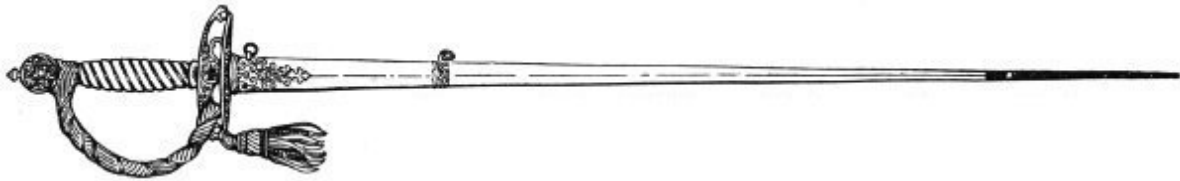


Through this gateway Washington and his guests were accustomed to pass from the main road. The original paving of cobble stones has been found intact and now visitors to Mount Vernon enter as in Washington's time. An attractive bowling-green extends from the gateway nearly to the Mansion. To the left are the flower gardens, and occupying a similar area to the right is the kitchen garden. These gardens are surrounded by brick walls, the coping of which was restored, in 1895, by Mrs. Christine Blair Graham, late Vice-Regent for Missouri.

Many of the old trees still bordering the original driveway have been identified from Washington's diary as having been planted by him or his

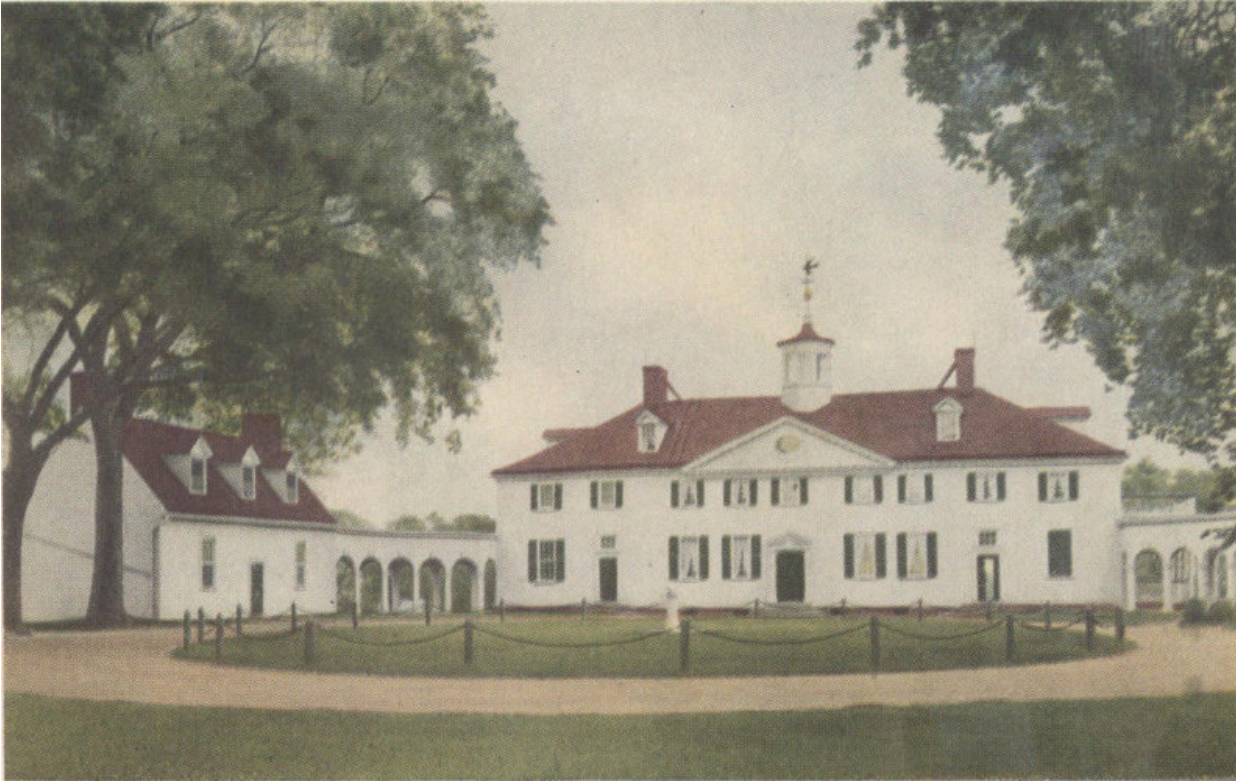
guests. Notably among them may be seen, near the Flower Garden entrance, two handsome tulip poplars—the tallest trees of the group.

On the lawn facing the Potomac are three large pecan trees which, as seedlings, came from Thomas Jefferson and were planted by Washington.



Sword worn by General Washington when he resigned Command of the Army in 1783, when he was inaugurated first President of U.S. 1789 and on all subsequent State occasions

West Front

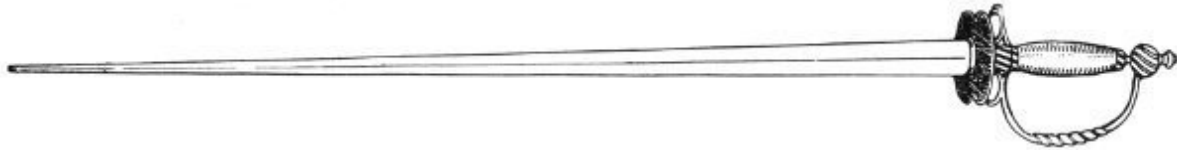


The west front of the Mansion was the point of approach for visitors, as indicated by the large central door bearing the original brass knocker. On this side is a spacious court, flanked by several frame buildings—to the right, the kitchen, butler's house, smoke-house, laundry and coach house, while to the left are the office, the gardener's house, carpenter shop and spinning house.

The kitchen and office are joined to the main building by colonnades, which were rebuilt in 1874 by the combined efforts of the late Vice-Regents for six States, as follows: Mrs. Hannah Blake Farnsworth, Michigan; Miss Lily Lytle Macalester, Pennsylvania; Miss Emily L. Harper, Maryland; Mrs. Lucy

H. Pickens, South Carolina; Mrs. Maria Brooks, New York, and Mrs. Nancy Wade Halstead, New Jersey.

The sun-dial in the center of the court marks where one stood in the days of Washington. The posts and chains are a restoration of an original feature, accomplished in 1917 by the Vice-Regent for Oregon.



Sword worn by Col. Washington as aide to General Braddock

North Lodge Gate



In 1892, when the Electric Railway located its terminal station near the north boundary of the estate, an entrance at that point had to be arranged for visitors. It is called the North Lodge Gate to distinguish it from the private entrance half a mile away. To provide an appropriate walkway to and from the Mansion, funds were raised, in 1894, by the late Vice-Regent for Pennsylvania—Mrs. Lippincott—and stone flagging laid the entire distance of 1,100 feet.

In 1900 the Vice-Regent for Texas, with financial aid from Masons and other patriotic citizens of her State, erected the present lodges and gateway.

The Vice-Regent for Texas and Mrs. Charles Denby, late Vice-Regent for Indiana, in 1905, jointly arranged for the building of a brick wall along the boundary next the North Lodge Gate, copying walls built elsewhere on the estate by General Washington.

The gradual extension of this wall is being accomplished through contributions of individual members of the Association.



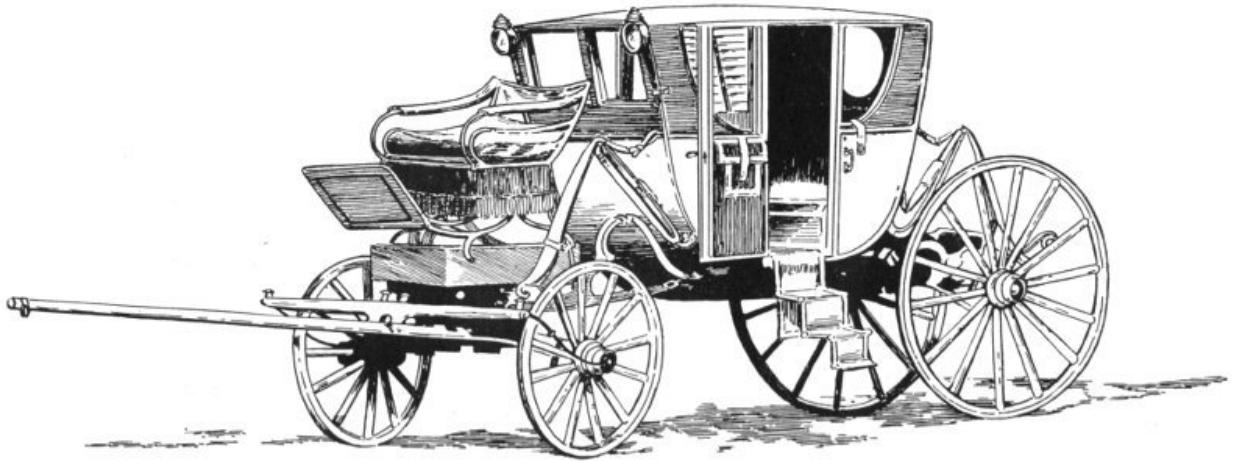
Dress sword worn by General Washington

West Lodge Gate



This was the main approach, in olden times, from the much-traveled highway to the homestead, which can be faintly discerned through a vista cleared by Washington. A carriage road winds through intervening valleys to the Mansion, nearly a mile distant. Extending from this gateway to the Potomac River is the part of the estate purchased in 1858 by the Mount Vernon Ladies' Association.

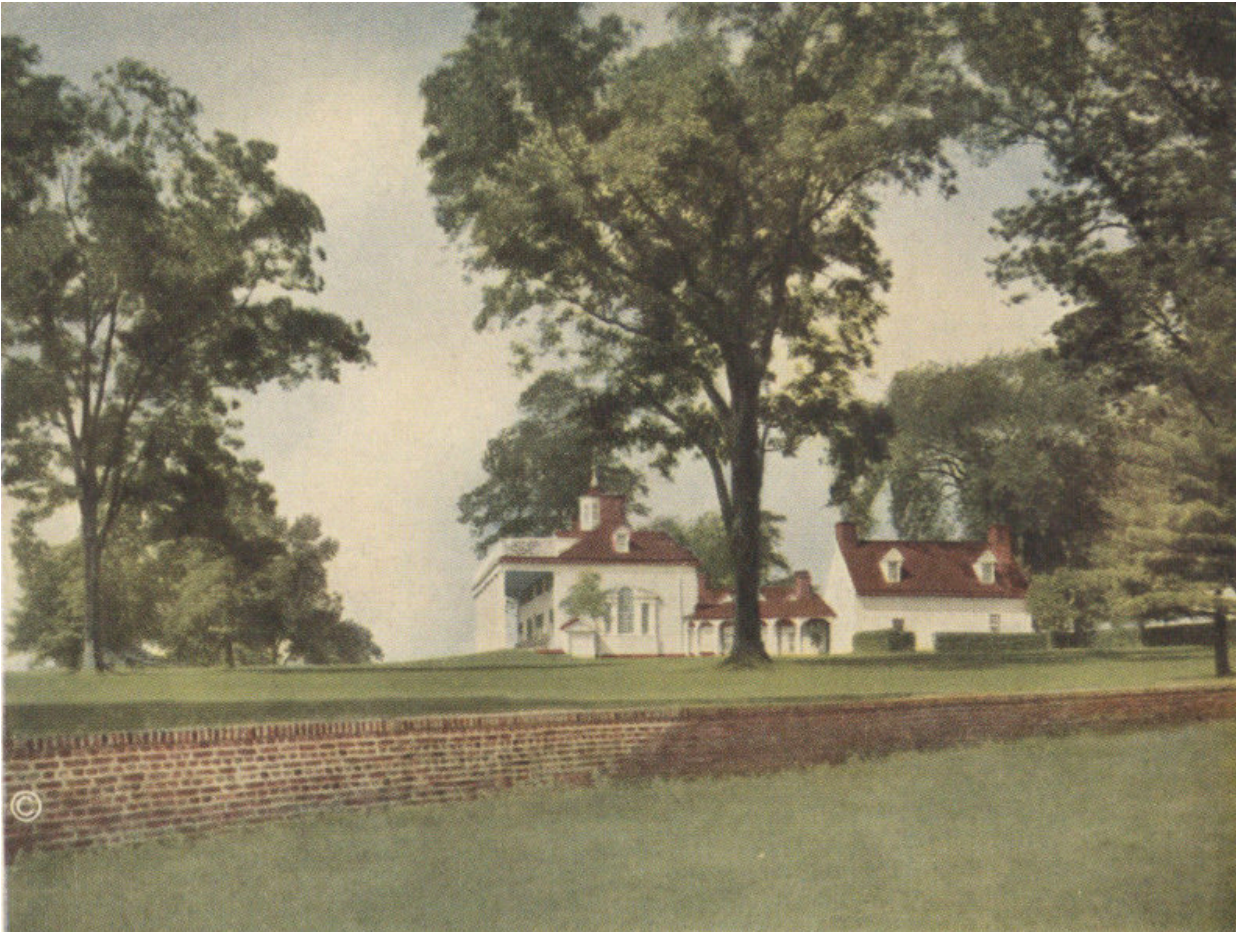
In 1890 Mrs. Martha Mitchell, late Vice-Regent for Wisconsin, provided funds for renovating these ancient lodges which once sheltered Washington's gatekeepers.



Duplicate of the coach in which General Washington made his tour of the South in 1791. The coach shown at Mount Vernon is a contemporary replica made by the same maker.

Mount Vernon Mansion

Construction



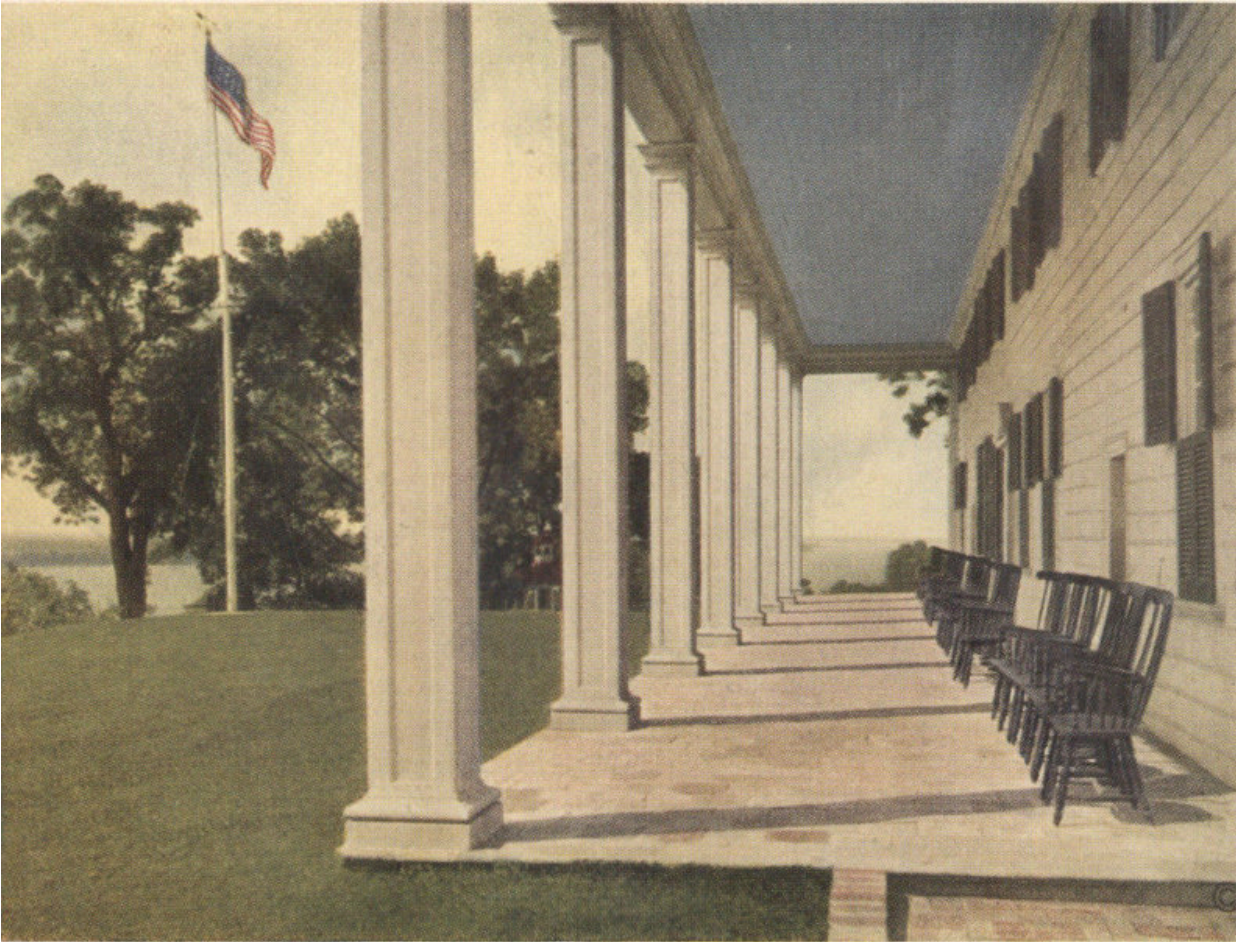
George Washington enlarged the original residence, built in 1743 by Lawrence Washington, by increasing its length and height, completing these improvements in 1786. In construction, its foundation walls are of stone and brick; the framework oak; the sheathing Virginia pine, cut, painted, and sanded to resemble stone. The roof is of cypress shingles. A spacious and well-drained cellar underlies the whole house.

When the Mount Vernon Ladies' Association came into possession of this property, the Mansion and other buildings were found unfurnished and greatly in need of repairs. The story of the restoration cannot be adequately told in this short sketch.

The work was divided by allotting to each Vice-Regent a room or some other feature to be restored. Gradually many articles of original furniture and personal effects of the Washingtons were recovered, some by gift, others by purchase, while several articles had only been loaned. The work has been attended with gratifying success and still progresses. Every effort is directed toward the complete restoration of each feature and condition as it existed in the days of Washington.

The "Ha Ha" wall, shown in illustration, was, in 1896, rebuilt upon its original foundations through funds raised by Miss Amy Townsend, late Vice-Regent for New York.

Portico



The east portico extends the full length of the Mansion, and its roof is supported by eight square wooden columns reaching a height of two stories. An ornamental balustrade surmounts the porch roof and adds height to its pleasing effect. The tiles with which the floor is still paved were imported from England by Washington and laid in 1786. In 1915, 1512 tiles were obtained from the original quarry to replace those so badly worn as to be unsafe. The dimensions of the pavement are: length, 95 feet 5 inches; width, 14 feet 6 inches, and, according to Washington's own measurements, this pavement is 124 feet 10½ inches above the river level. The columns and

balustrade are faithful reproductions of the original, the foundations of the building have been strengthened, weakened timbers renewed, and steel girders hidden between floors and ceiling for increased stability.

In 1895 accurate architectural drawings of interior and exterior details were secured by Mrs. Mary T. Leiter, late Vice-Regent for Illinois, and placed in safe deposit vaults in Washington.

In 1909 a skeleton model of the Mansion, showing its unique construction, was lodged for safe keeping with the National Museum.

The outlook from the porch commands extensive and picturesque views of the broad Potomac.

Mansion Interior, Central Hall

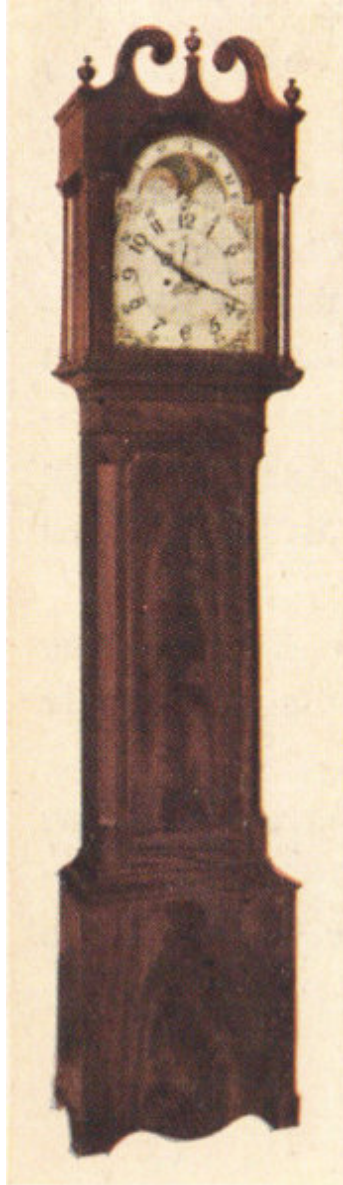


The view of the hall is from the East, showing the main stairway. To the right, doors open into the Music Room and Parlor; to the left are Mrs. Washington's Sitting Room and the Family Dining Room. The paneling of the hall is as Washington improved it in 1775, and the original colors are restored. The pattern of wall paper above the stairs has been worked out from recently discovered fragments of what was originally there. The key of the Bastille, presented to Washington by Lafayette, in 1789, hangs in a glass case between the doors on the left, while opposite may be seen the brass hunting horn received from the same friend.

Four of Washington's swords are shown: one he used during the Braddock campaign; his dress sword (damaged by rust); a sword made for him at the

Solingen Armory in Prussia; the silver-mounted blade he wore when resigning command of the army (1783) and at his inauguration in 1789. In the case with the swords is the sash worn by General Braddock when he was wounded, and given by him to Col. George Washington, who was then his aide-de-camp.

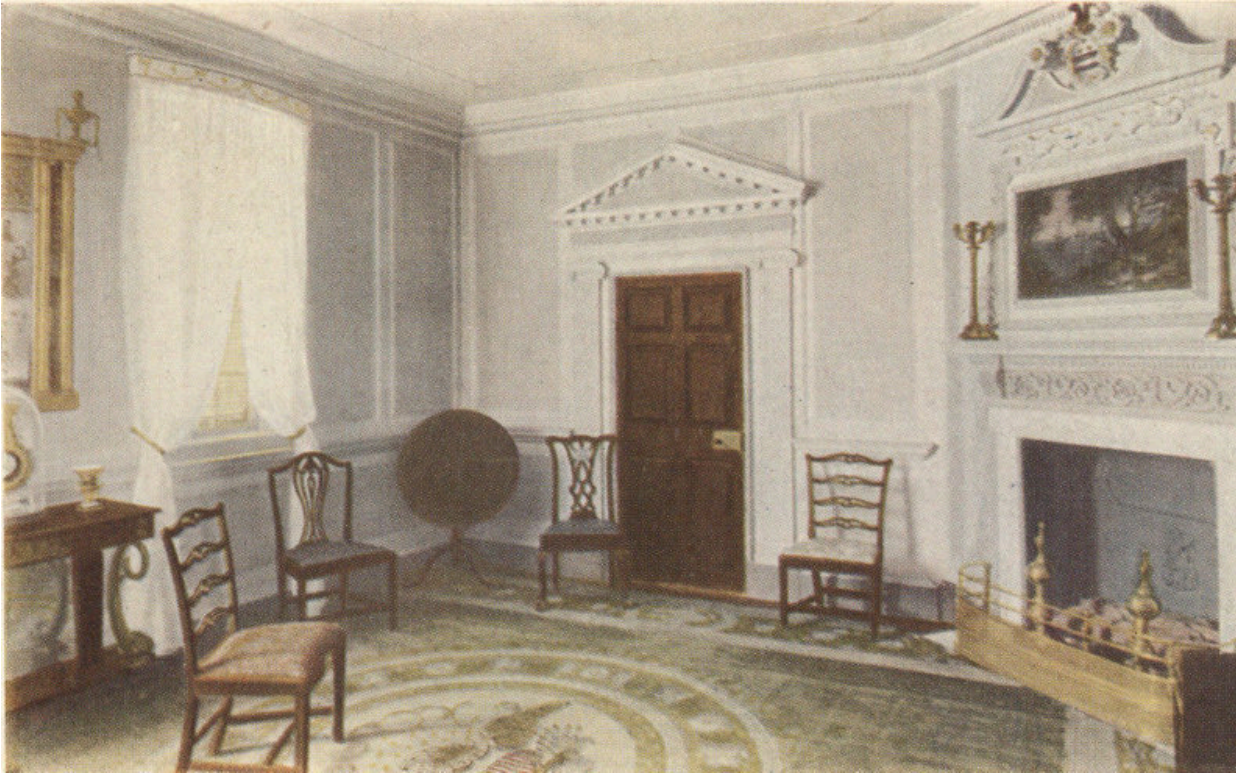
By his will, Washington bequeathed to each of his nephews one of his five swords, with the following injunction: “Not to unsheathe them for the purpose of shedding blood except it be in self-defence or in the defence of their country and its rights, and in the latter case to keep them unsheathed and prefer falling with them in their hands to the relinquishment thereof.”



The clock on the stairs belonged to Lawrence Washington, the founder of Mount Vernon, and the hall lantern was given to him (1745) by Admiral Vernon, for whom the estate was named.

The marble top table belonged to Washington, and the engravings are reprints of originals. The restoration of the hall is due to the Vice-Regents for Michigan and Alabama.

West Parlor

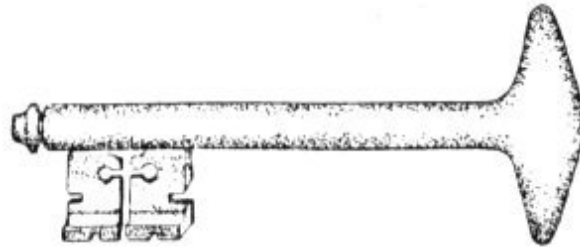


The finish of this room—its wall panels, mantel and ceiling decoration—is a restoration of the original. Washington's coat of arms is carved above the mantel, and his crest and initials are cast in the heavy fireback. An old painting empaneled over the mantel is said to represent a part of Admiral Vernon's fleet at Cartagena, and was sent by the Admiral to Lawrence Washington in 1743 as an acknowledgment of Washington's courtesy in naming the estate for him.

The rug in the room is particularly interesting. It was woven by order of Louis XVI, and sent by him as a present to General Washington.

The curtain cornices are original, also the mirror, now restored to its former position between the windows, and two rosewood stands for vases of

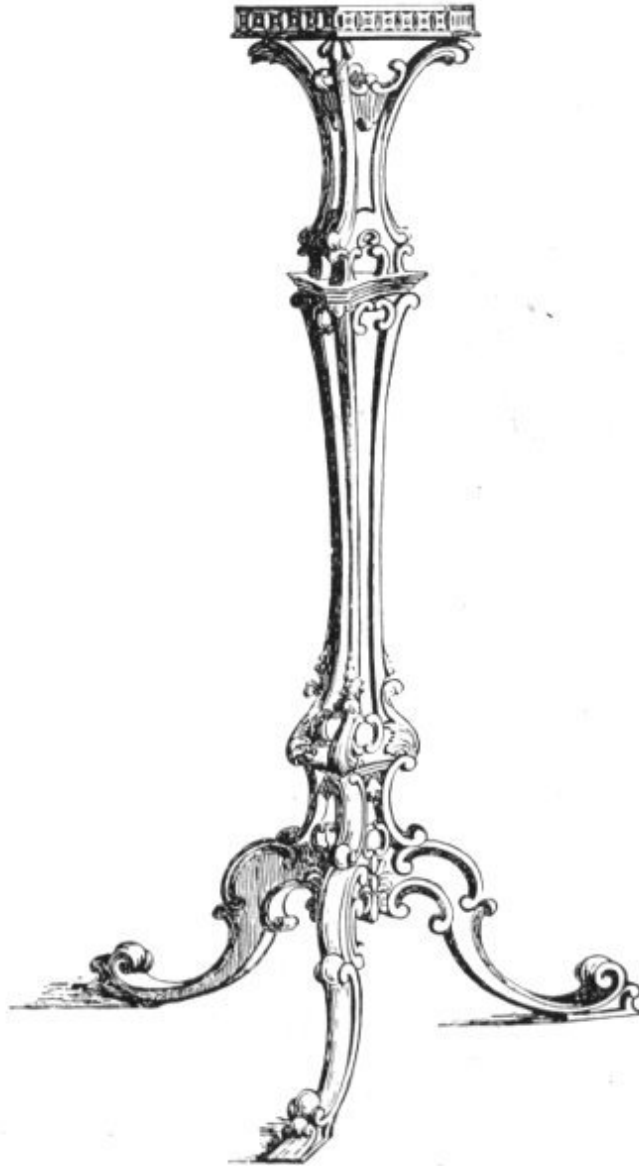
flowers.



Key of the Bastille

Among articles of interest gathered by Mrs. Mary T. Leiter, late Vice-Regent for Illinois, are several of the old chairs and a reprint of an engraving of Louis XVI.

The old piano and handsome French clock are contemporaneous but did not belong to the Washingtons.



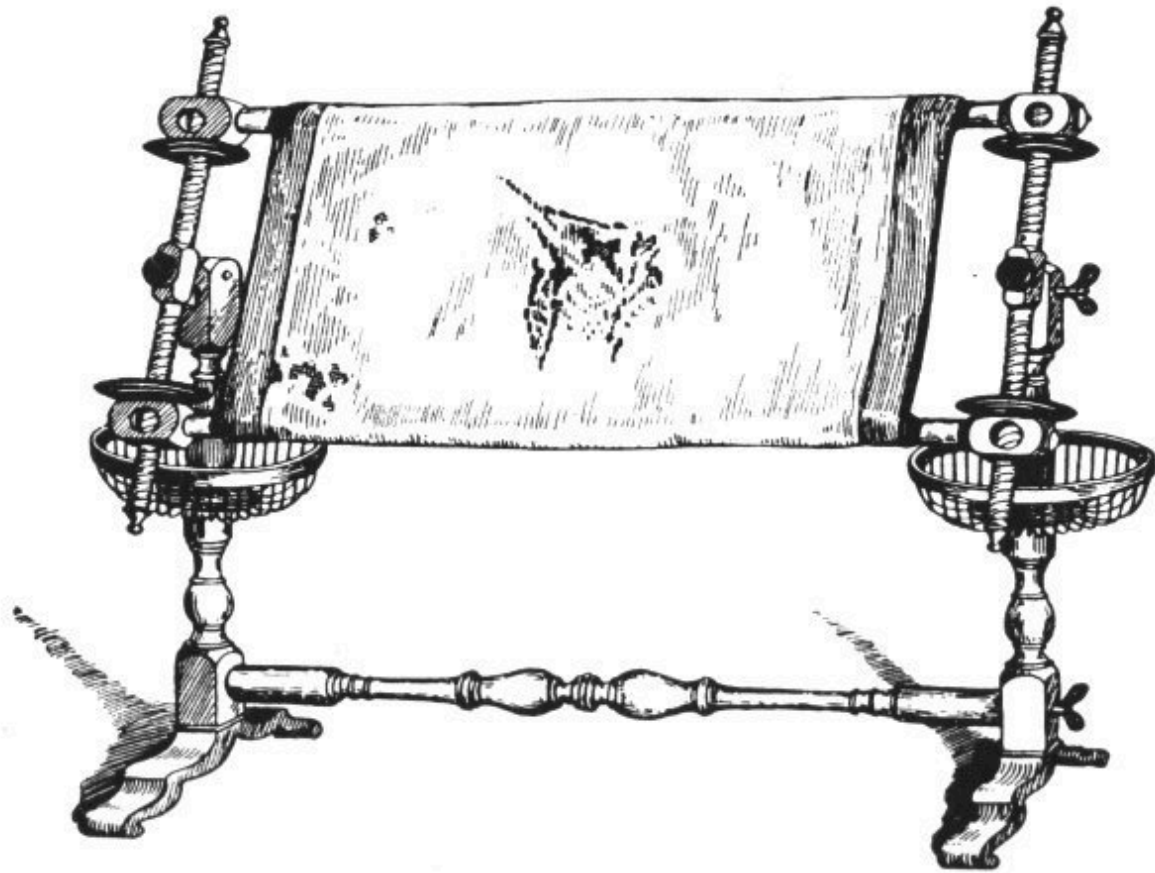
Tripod stand

Miss Custis's Music Room



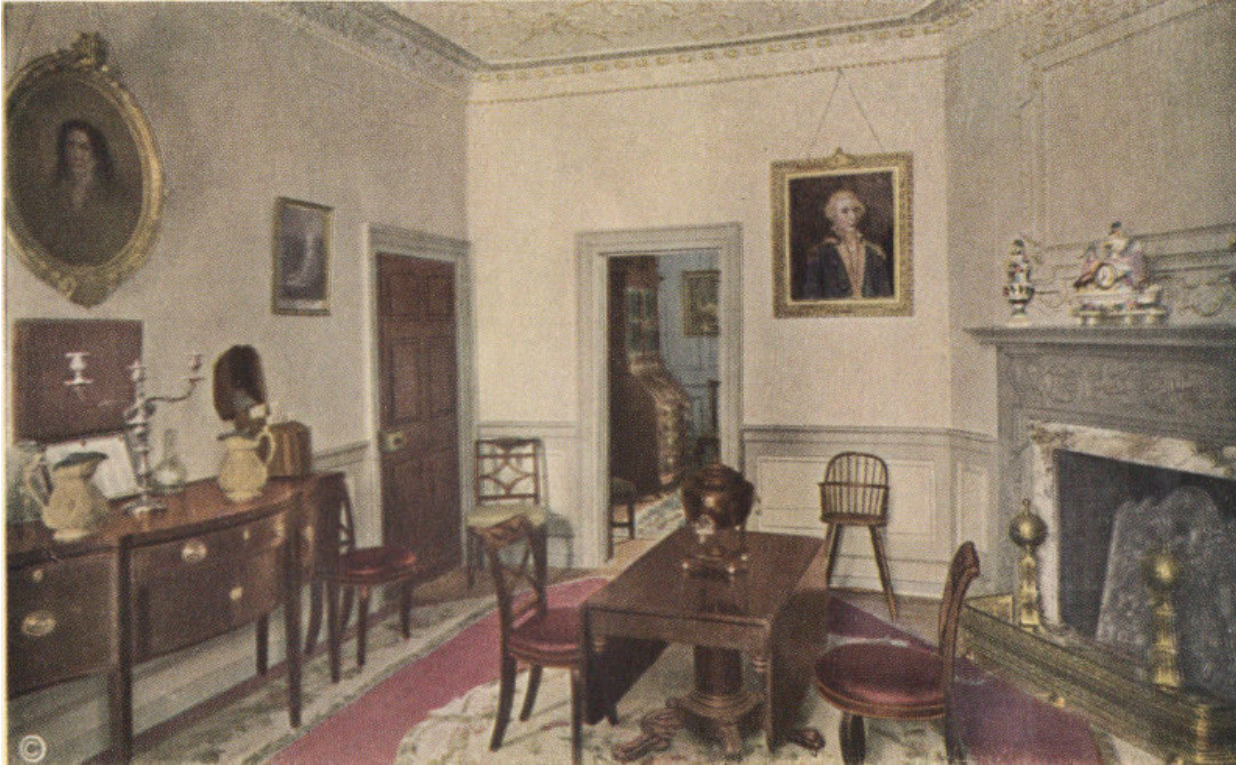
The prominent feature here is the harpsichord which General Washington presented to Nellie Custis. The stool belonged to Nellie Custis. There is also some of her embroidery on an old tambour frame. Here may be seen Washington's flute, and two of his chairs; also a citra, or guitar, and a card table, which belonged to relatives of Washington. A quaint old music book has been found, bearing the autograph of Martha Parke Custis, the step-daughter of Washington.

This room is in the care of the Vice-Regent for Ohio.



Tambour Frame

Family Dining Room



The Vice-Regent for South Carolina has furnished this room. The Heppelwhite sideboard is original. All the furniture is of ancient form. The rug is of the Washington period, as are also the handsome brass andirons and fender. In the corner cupboard may be seen a reproduction of the set of china presented to Mrs. Washington by the officers of the French fleet. The stucco ornamentation of the ceiling is the same as applied in 1775. An iron fireback bearing the Fairfax coat of arms, stands in the fireplace. It was at the Fairfax home, "Belvoir," adjoining Mount Vernon. The clock and rose jars were Lafayette's.

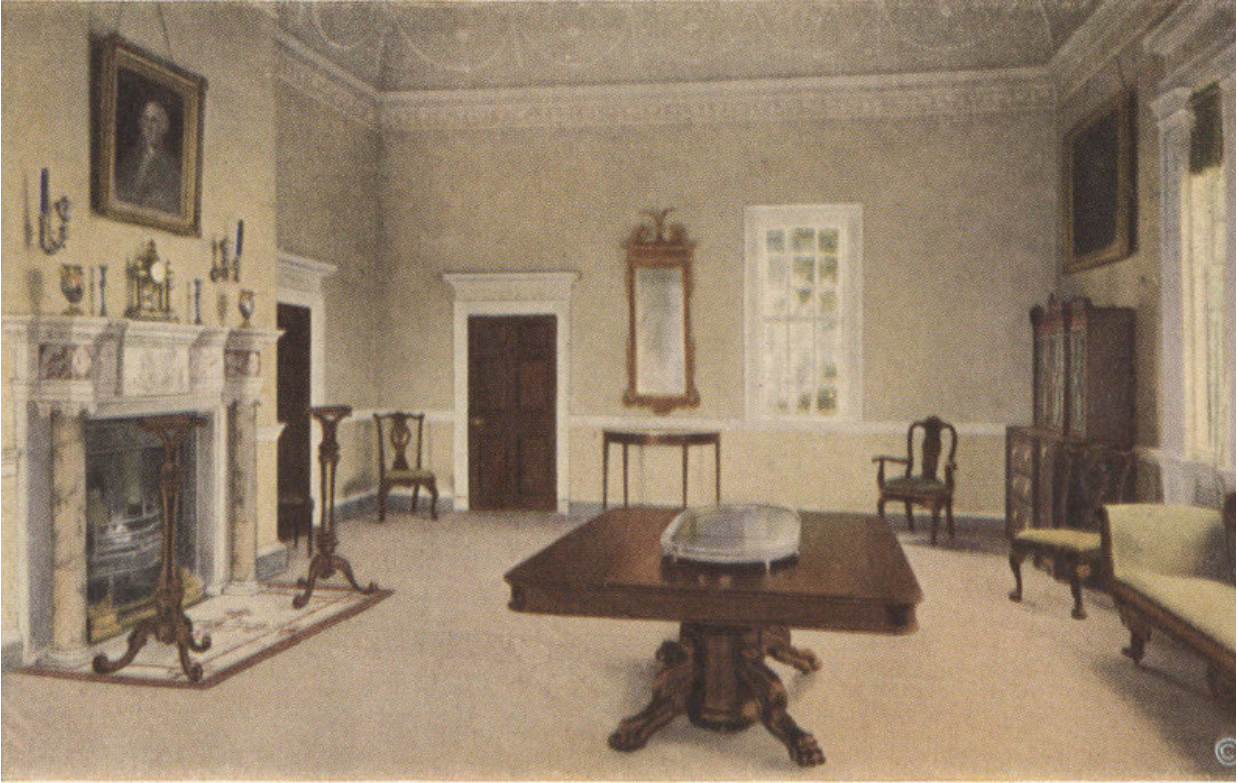


A pair of handsome pitchers, Washington's wine chest, two wine decanters and glass, all of which are authentic, have been lately added, also a chair Washington owned at Cambridge.

Here also is a portrait of David Rittenhouse, which he presented to Washington.

The memorial tablet to Miss Cunningham, of South Carolina, founder of the Mount Vernon Ladies' Association, has been appropriately given place here with her portrait.

Banquet Hall

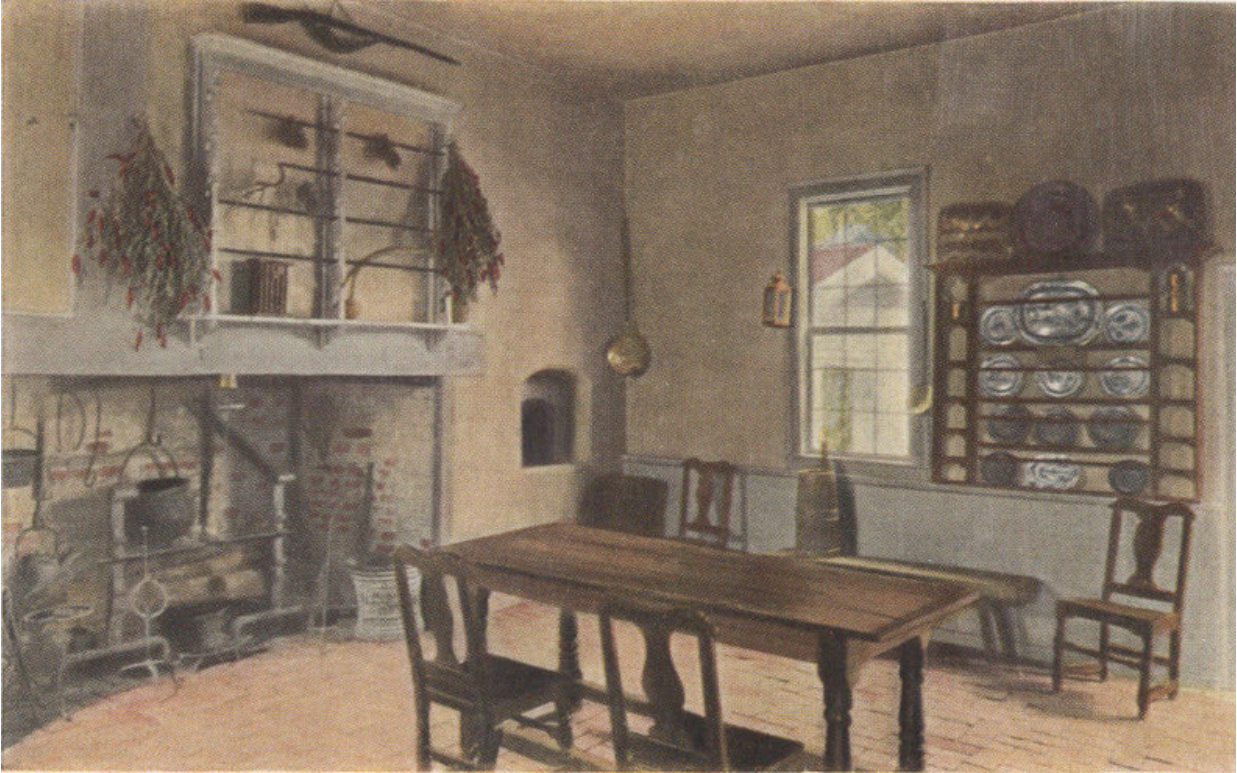


This well-proportioned room was planned by Washington for the banquet hall, and this addition, in 1776, completed the enlargement of his house—now dignified by the name of Mansion. The decoration throughout is as he designed it; the present fresh appearance of which is the result of restorations (1884) by Mrs. Justine Van Renssalaer Townsend, then Vice-Regent for New York. An attractive feature is the handsome marble mantel presented to Washington in 1785 by an English admirer, Mr. Samuel Vaughan. The model of the Bastille is made from a stone from the renowned French prison and was sent over by Lafayette in 1793. A plateau for ornamenting his dining table was imported by Washington. Among original relics recovered for this room are the clock, candlesticks and vases, two quaint silver bracket lamps, a footstool from Washington's pew in Old Trinity Church, N. Y., and

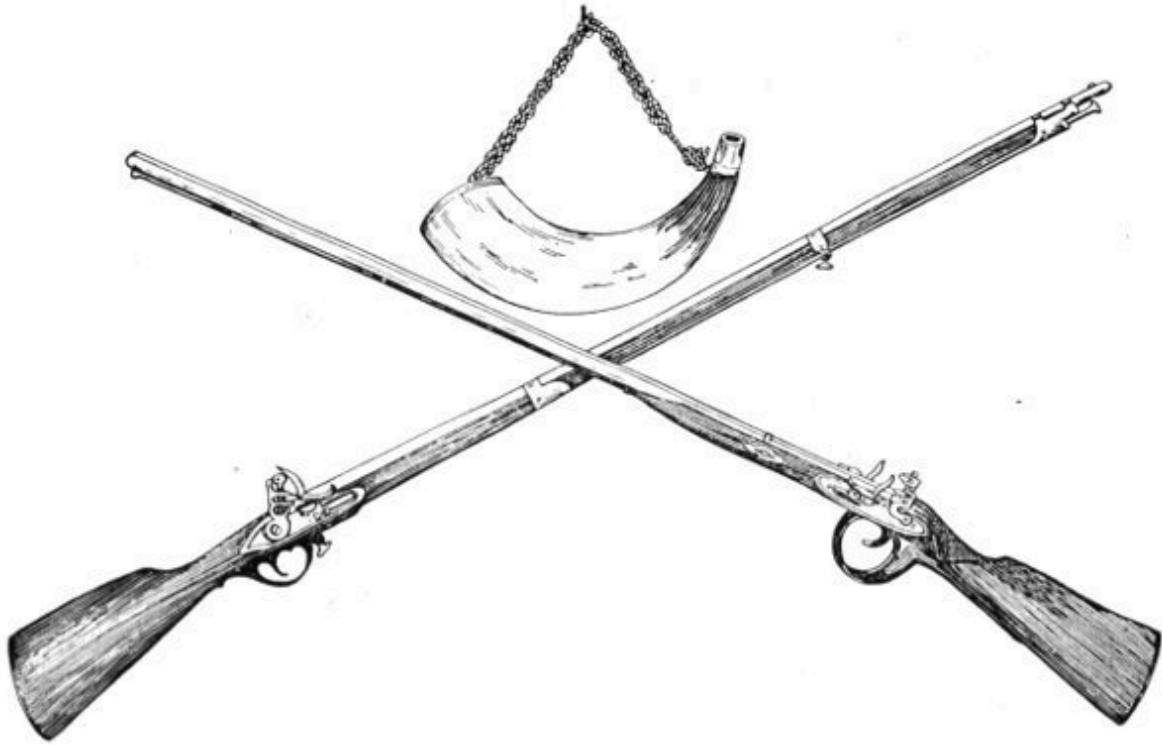
paintings of the Great Falls of the Potomac. There are portraits of Washington by Gilbert Stuart and C. W. Peale, also a supposed portrait of Washington at the age of twenty-one, recently sent over from Glasgow as a loan.



Kitchen

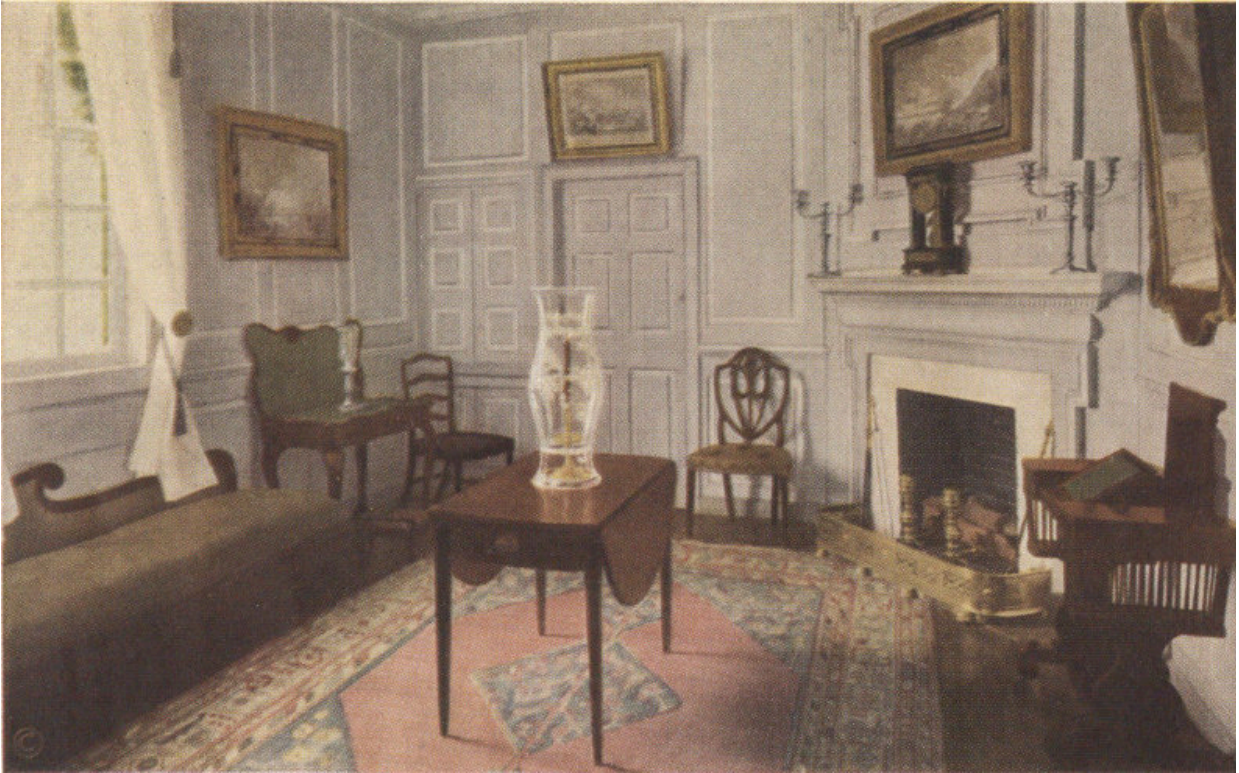


A tour of inspection among the several buildings develops points of interest at every turn. The family kitchen bears evidence, in the proportions of its huge fireplace with ponderous crane and bake-oven near by, of what feasts were prepared therein. The interior of this room was renovated by Miss Amy Townsend, late Vice-Regent for New York, who obtained for it furnishings of contemporaneous date. The smoke-house stood near, and in season was filled with hams and meats for smoking. The larder was well stocked, tradition states, as indeed it must have been, to feed so many guests in addition to the regular household and large retinue of servants.

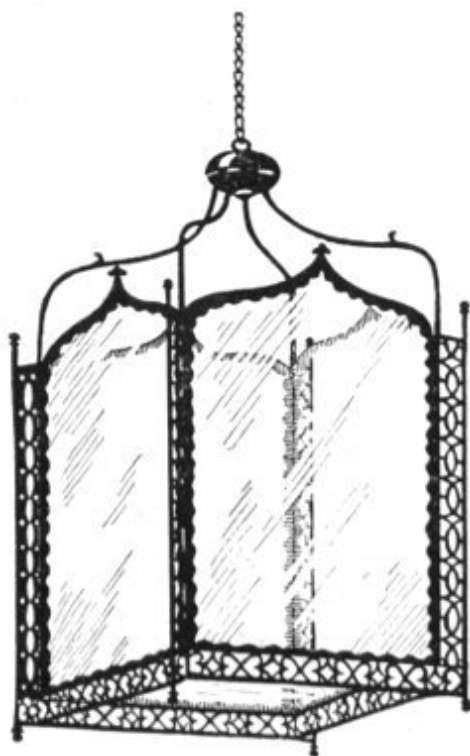


***Powder Horn used by one of the “Minute Men” at the Battle of Concord
Charleville Musket brought by General Lafayette in 1777
Shot Gun sometime used by General Washington***

Mrs. Washington's Sitting Room



The sitting room is in the care of the Vice-Regent for Georgia. The card table and mirror are original Washington articles of considerable interest. The silver candlestick was owned by Col. William Washington, a nephew of the General. It was presented by Mrs. Georgia Page Wilder, late Vice-Regent for Georgia. The four prints representing the siege of Gibraltar are those which hung at Mount Vernon in the days of Washington. The window curtains and hangings are of the type of that period. A mahogany chair, presented to Washington by Lafayette, is a recent acquisition. One of the candles moulded for the illumination of Yorktown in 1776 is a relic of unique character. A couch which once belonged to Nellie Custis has recently been added.





Library



This is one of the rooms General Washington added. It was designed for his study, as shown by the old book shelves built in the wall. Back of opposite doors were shelf rooms for his maps and manuscripts. The bulk of Washington's library he bequeathed to Judge Bushrod Washington, from whose nephews the books were purchased by a syndicate (1848) and deposited in the Boston Athenæum, where they still are. Some scattered volumes recovered by the Mount Vernon Ladies' Association include several bearing the genuine signature of George Washington. The names of his mother and members of his family appear upon others. An ancient Bible presented to Washington by the Bishop of Sodor and Man, together with twenty volumes of French History of Travel, sent him by Rochambeau, besides many duplicates of Washington's books, give interesting character to

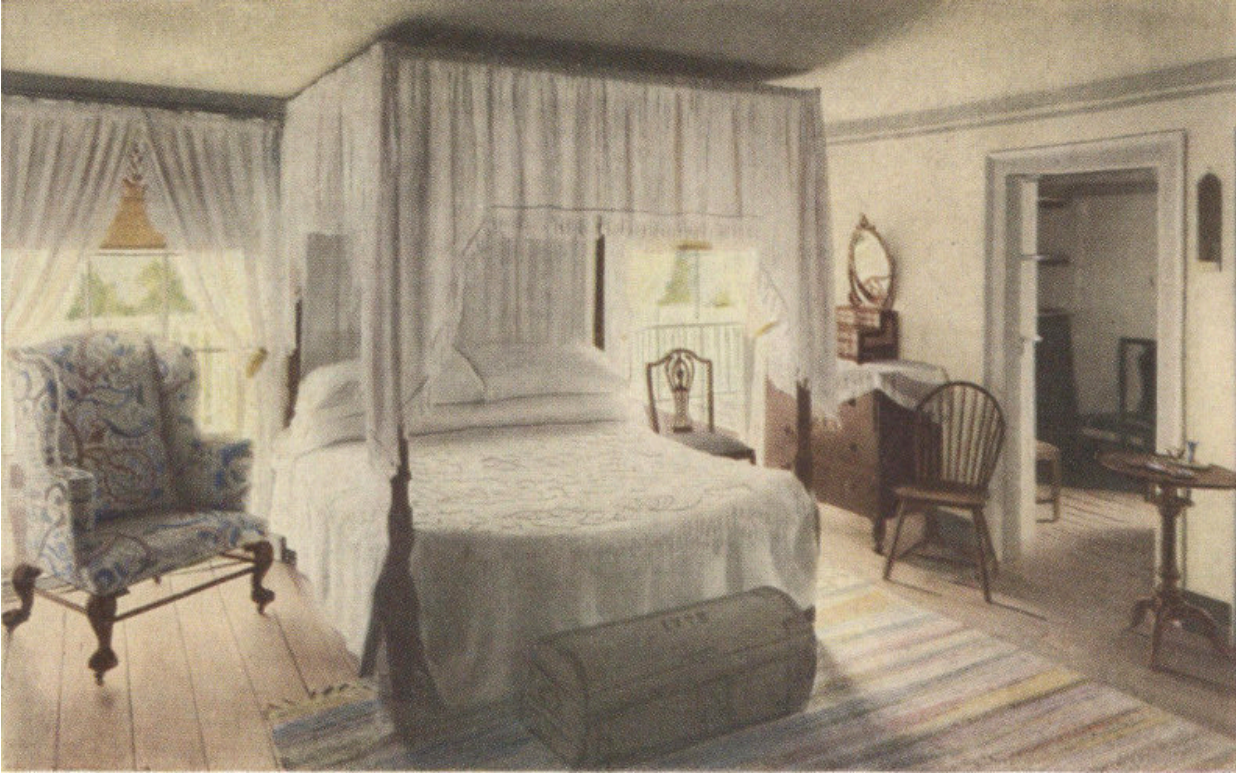
the present collection. Mrs. Washington's Prayer Book, and a Family Bible with record of George Washington's birth and baptism, have lately been acquired.

The "tambour desk" and chair, which Washington used in this room, and left by his will to Dr. Craik, were purchased and restored to Mount Vernon in 1905.

An original mahogany bookcase and a globe are valued relics. The pictures, tambour desk and articles of old-fashioned furniture have been assembled by the Vice-Regent for Massachusetts.

A map of Mount Vernon, and of one of Washington's plantations, carefully platted by himself, are to be seen here, likewise "rubblings" of brasses on tombs of the Washingtons in England.

Washington's Room



The room in which Washington died (December 14, 1799) deservedly attracts special notice. The items of original furniture and personal effects assembled here add much to the impressive character. A piece associated with Washington's childhood is his mother's arm chair. Washington's bureau, washstand, mirror, etc., are shown. Most prominent of all is the bedstead on which the great and good man breathed his last.

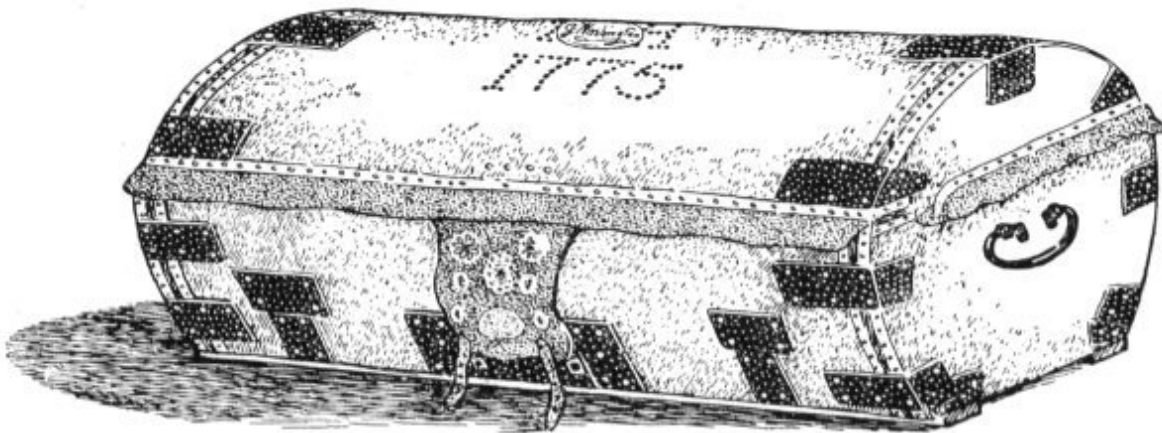
The mahogany shaving stand presented to Washington by the first French minister to this country was recently recovered.

Washington's crest and initials are wrought in the old fireback. Above the mantel hangs an engraving, one of a set of five entitled "Sorrows of

Werther,” which belonged to the General. The arm chair at the foot of the bed was used in this room when Washington died.

The two small rooms connecting with the bed-chamber were used respectively as linen closet and dressing room. Between the doors of these rooms now hangs the frame of Washington’s thermometer.

To the efforts of the late Mrs. Emma Reed Ball, for 44 years the Vice-Regent for Virginia, is due, in great measure, the restoration of this room.



Mrs. Washington's Room

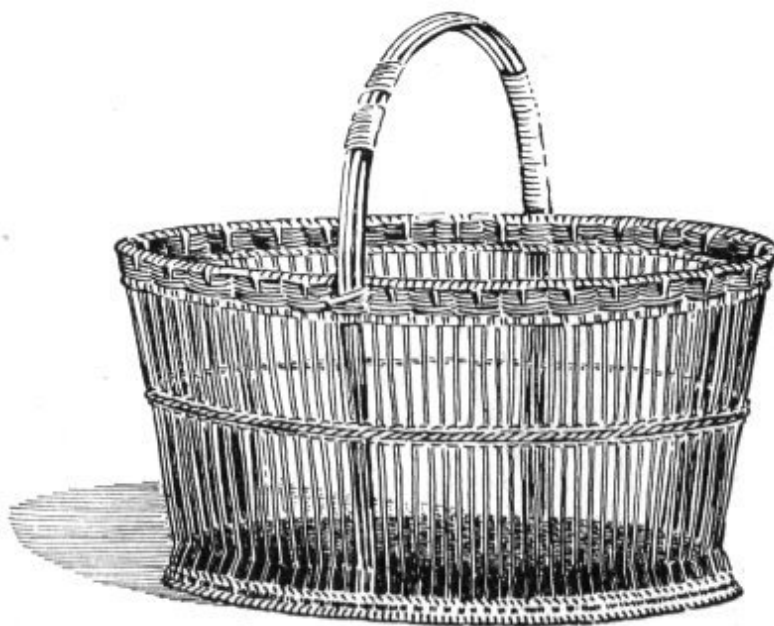


The only room on the third floor historically interesting is the one in which Mrs. Washington died. It must be explained that, following a custom then prevalent, Washington's room was closed after his death, and his widow selected this attic room because from its only window she could see the tomb where her husband's body lay. Mrs. Washington died here, May 22, 1802.

Until recently, the only original relics in this room were the washstand presented by Mrs. Martha Mitchell, late Vice-Regent for Wisconsin, and dressing glass presented by Mrs. George R. Goldsborough, late Vice-Regent for Maryland. Now have been added a tea set owned by Mrs. Washington, a christening bowl which belonged to Mrs. Washington's family—the

Dandriges—and an old bed quilt believed to have been used at Mount Vernon.

The care of this room fell to the Vice-Regent for Wisconsin.



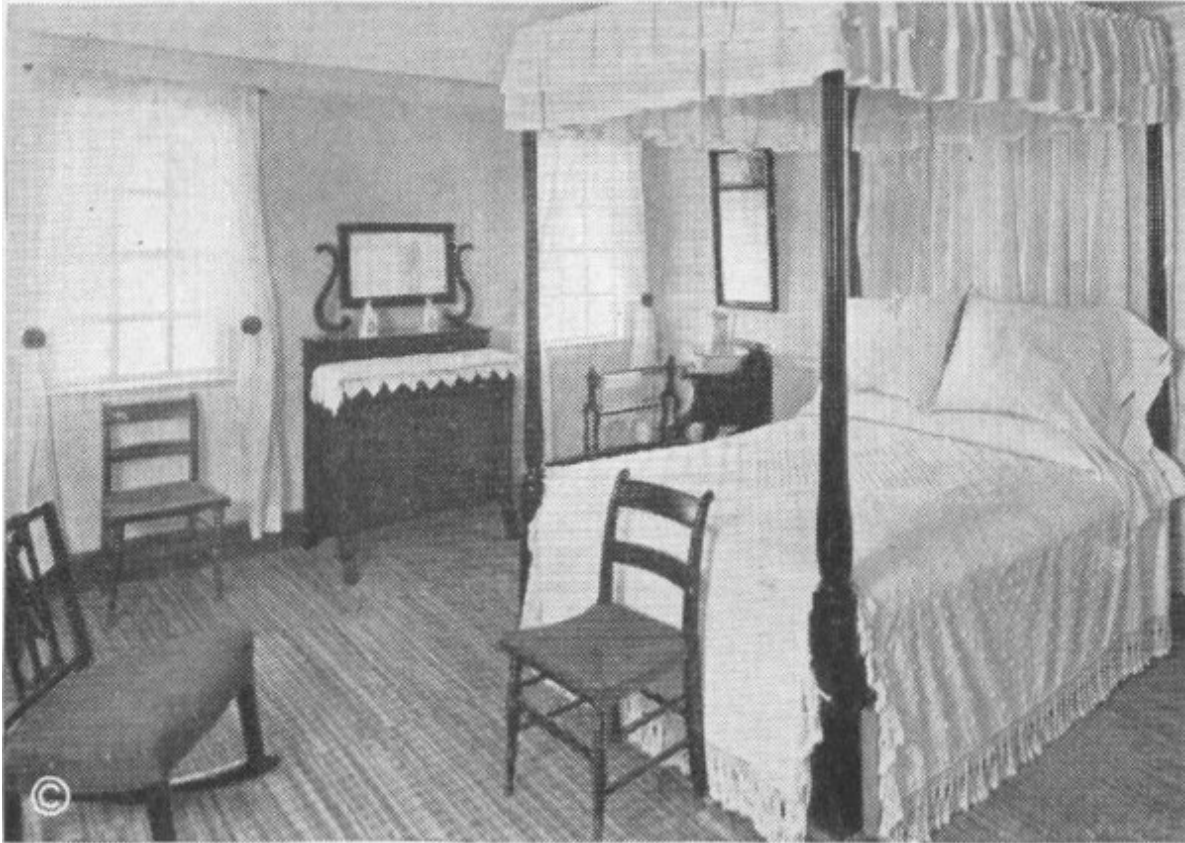
Second Floor

Ascending by the stairway, from the main hall to the second floor, six bedrooms are found—the Lafayette Room, River Room, Guest Chamber, Nellie Custis Room, Green Room and Mrs. Washington's Room. These are in charge of the Vice-Regents representing, respectively, the following States: New Jersey, Pennsylvania, Delaware, Maryland, West Virginia and Virginia. The first five rooms contain but little original furniture, although all the articles are of historic importance and represent the correct type of the Colonial period.

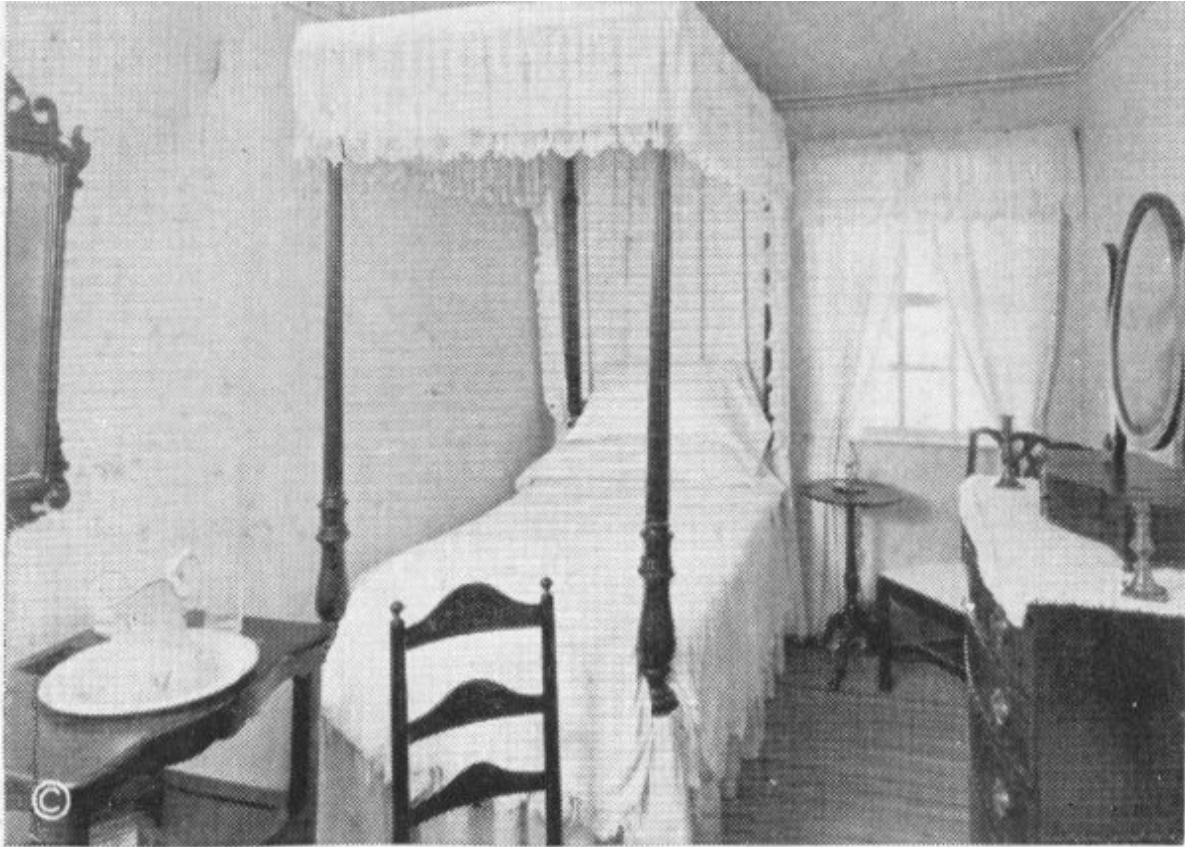
In the Nellie Custis Room are a table cover and footstool embroidered by her.



LAFAYETTE ROOM



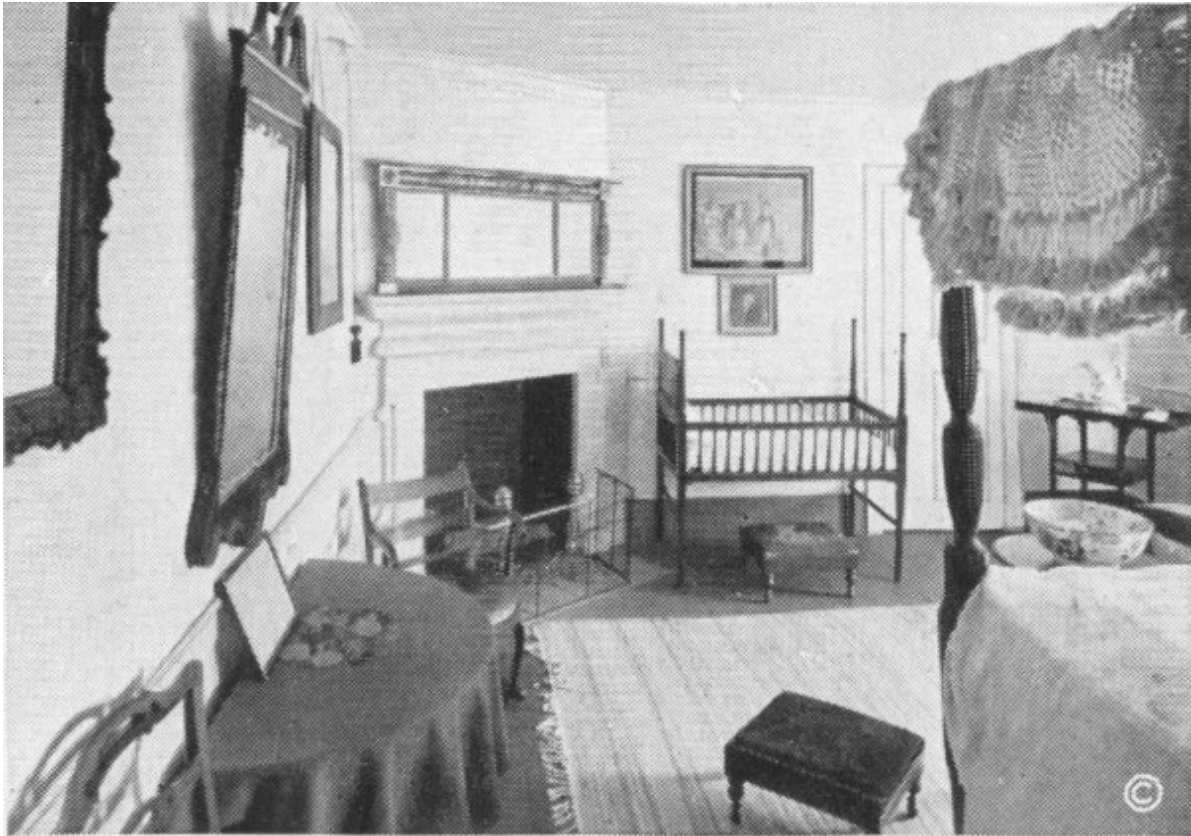
RIVER ROOM



GUEST ROOM



GREEN ROOM



NELLIE CUSTIS ROOM



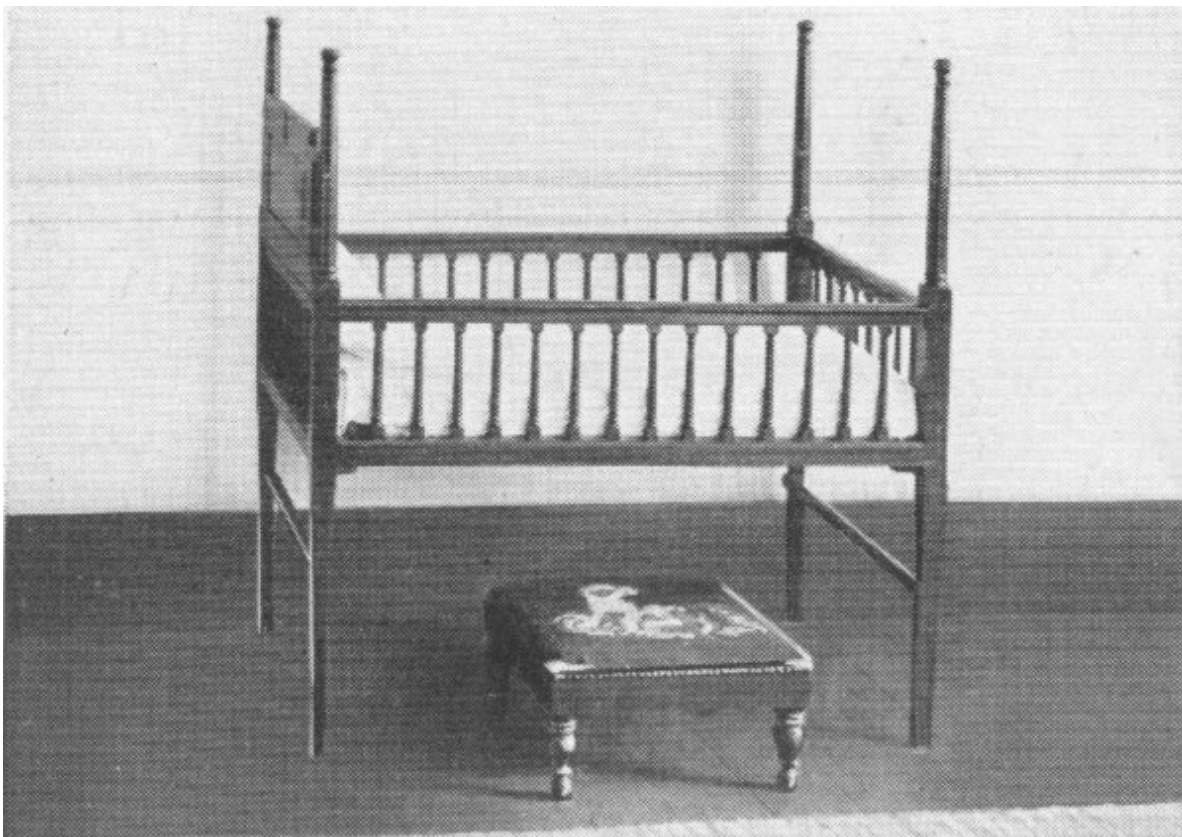
Third Floor

Spare rooms, third floor, furnished by States named

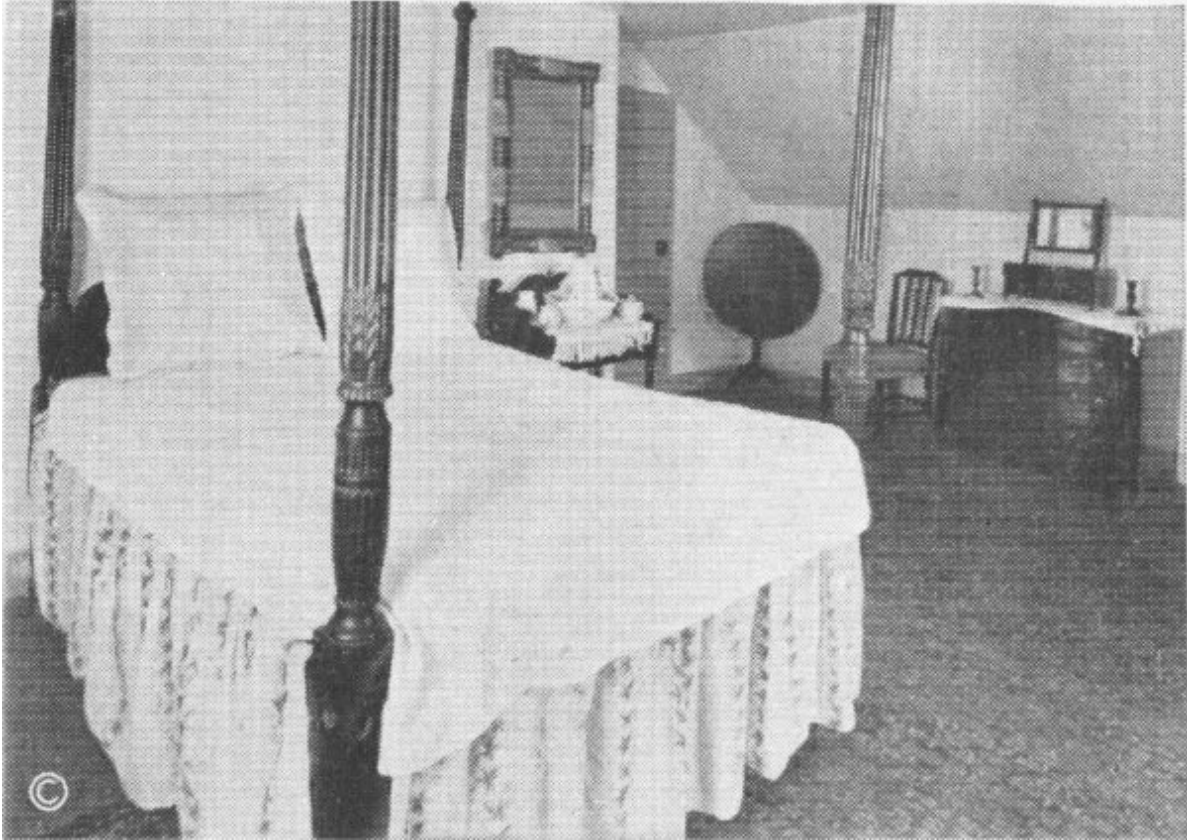
The four spare rooms on this floor are furnished appropriately after the old style, by the Vice-Regents for District of Columbia, Connecticut, North Carolina and Maine. Formerly the Washingtons found these rooms useful as spare chambers for the accommodation of guests. The good old custom of keeping “open house” attracted to Mount Vernon hosts of their friends traveling North and South, and doubtless the Mansion was often taxed to its fullest capacity.

In the linen room on this floor may be seen Washington’s military chest, and camp equipments used by his troops when serving with General Braddock.

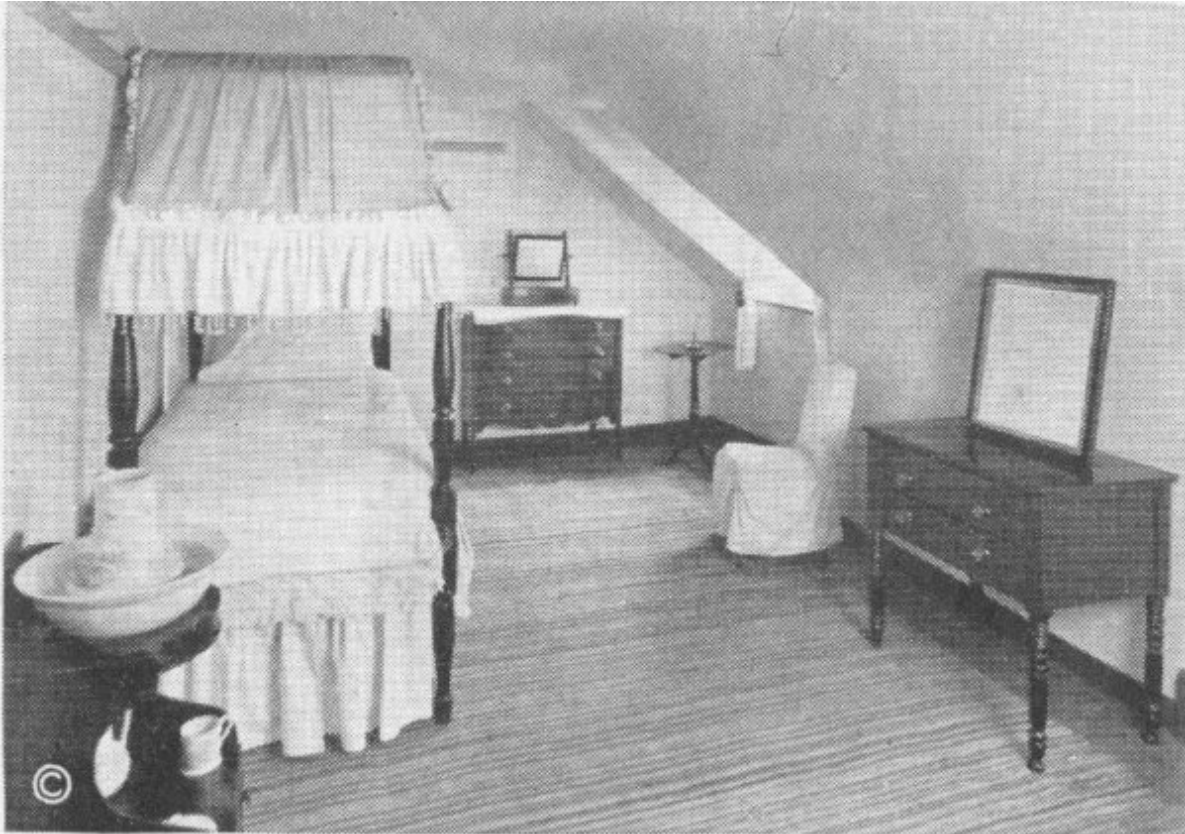
One of the chairs in the room furnished by Mrs. Mary T. Barnes, the late Vice-Regent for District of Columbia, belonged to Washington.



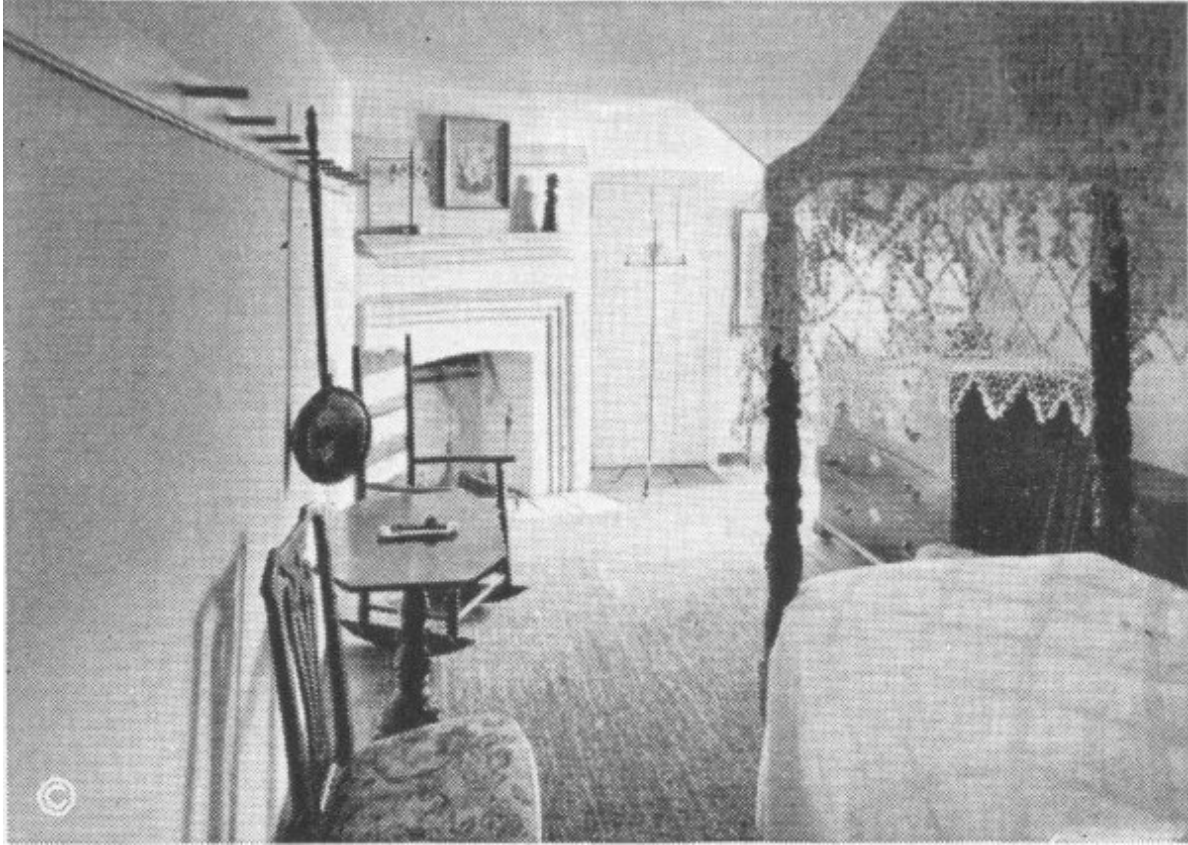
FOOTSTOOL—CRIB IN NELLIE CUSTIS ROOM



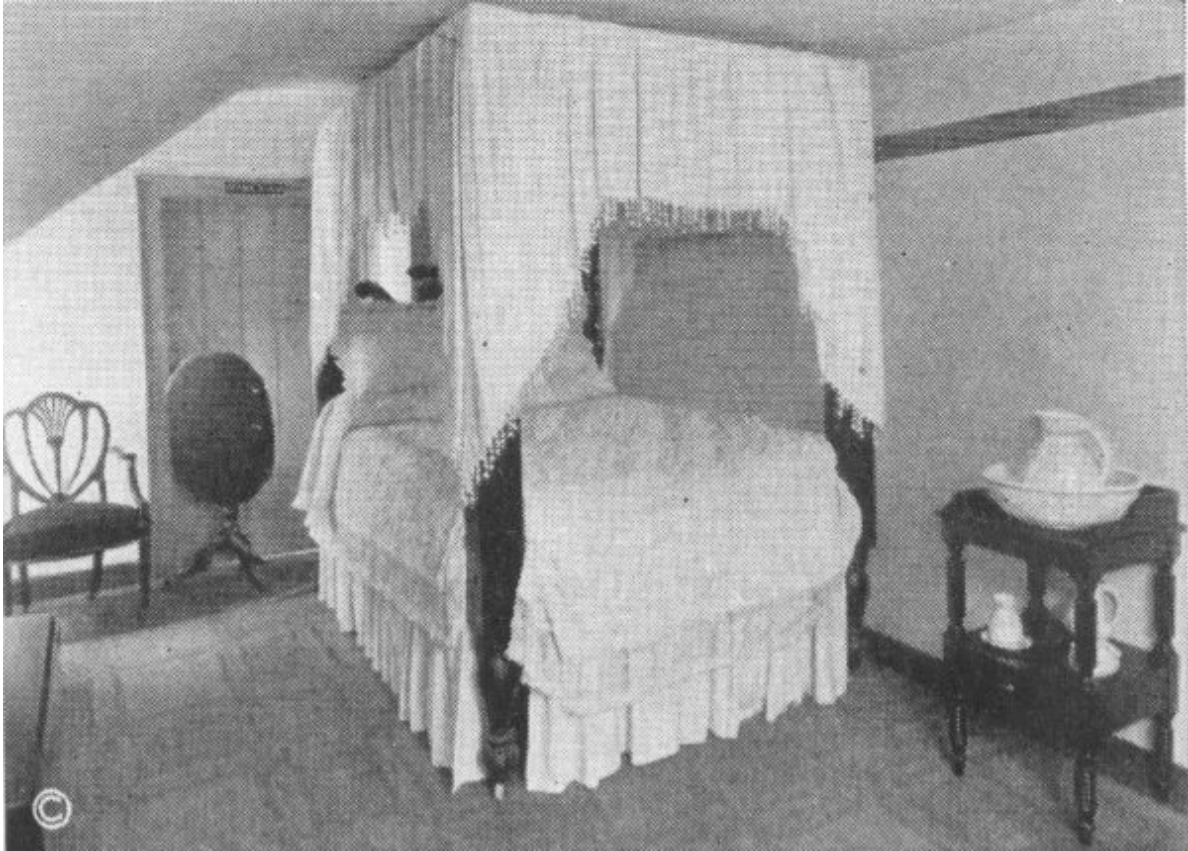
SPARE ROOM



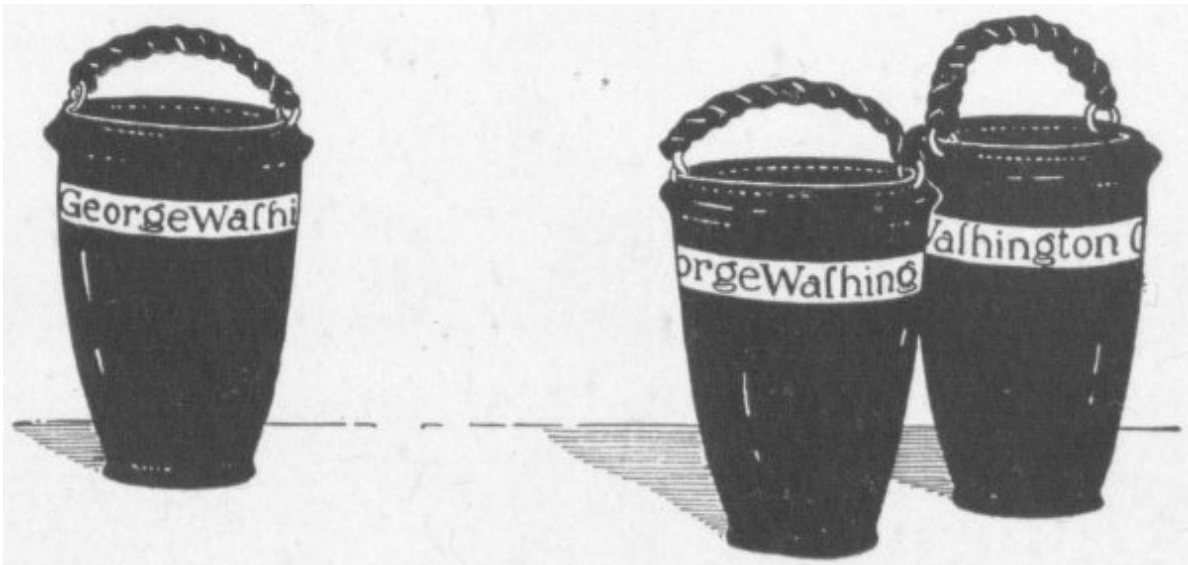
SPARE ROOM



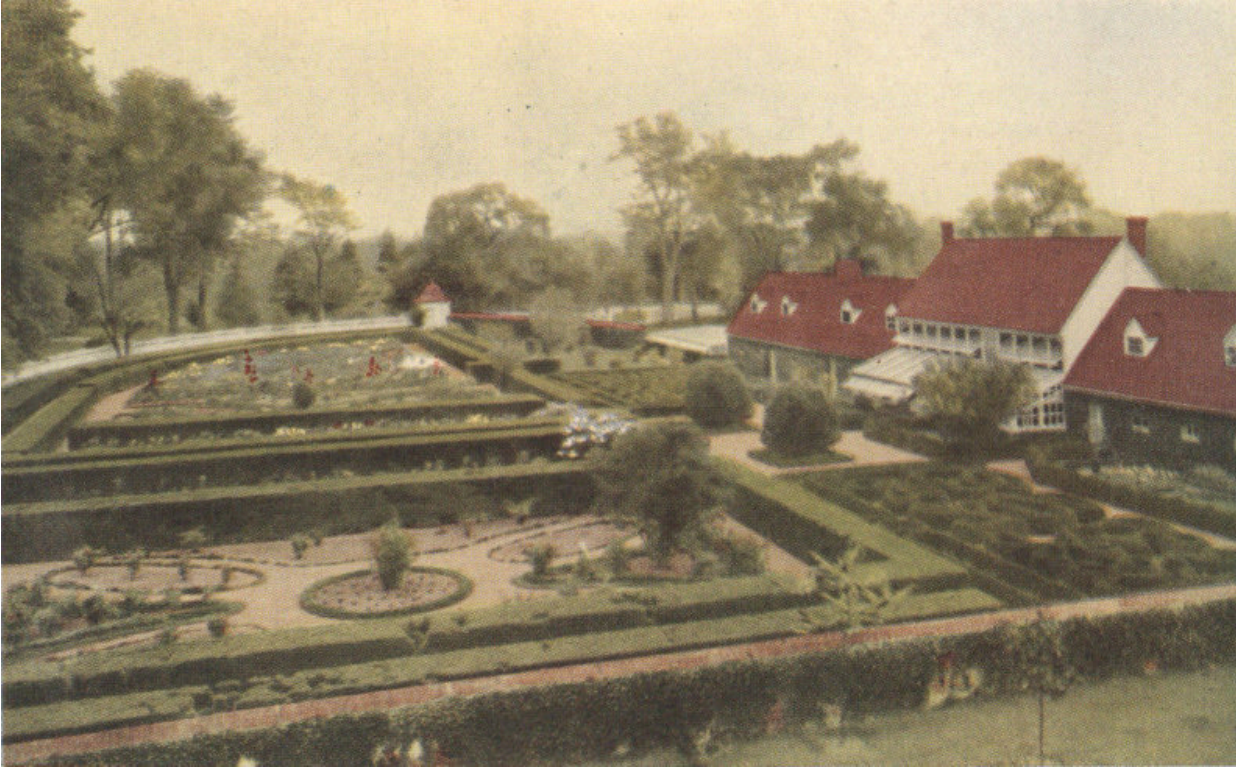
SPARE ROOM



SPARE ROOM



Flower Garden



Among all of the charms and attractions of the home of Washington, not one can excel the beautiful flower garden—an ideal spot—with its memories of General and Lady Washington who planned it, the prim box hedges indelibly marking the walks and flower beds now as in the past. Distinguished guests were invited to plant trees, shrubs and flowers, mementos of their visits, many of which plantings have been perpetuated. Lafayette and Jefferson have leafy monuments here, while the roses named by Washington for his mother and Nellie Custis are daily sought by pilgrims.

At the end of the long walk in the garden is a little octagonal structure known as the school room, in which it is supposed the Custis children were taught their early lessons.

The greenhouse restorations are due to the efforts of Mrs. Martha Mitchell, Mrs. Lucy H. Pickens and Miss Mary Lloyd Pendleton, late Vice-Regents, respectively, for Wisconsin, South Carolina and Ohio.

Servants' Quarters

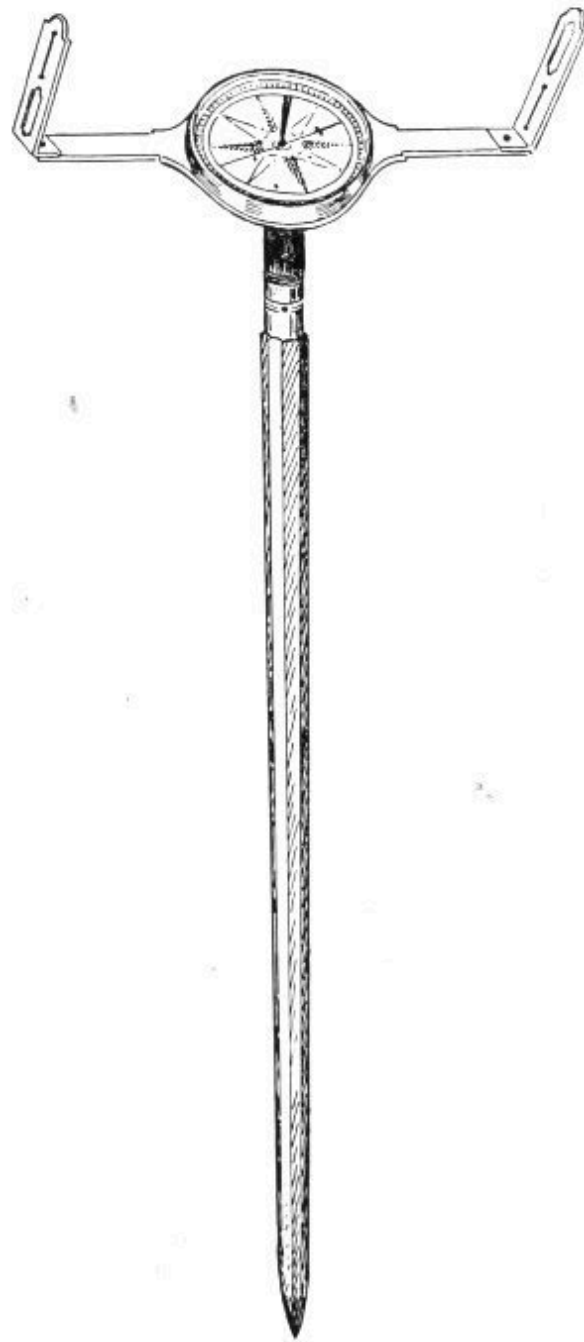
Two long, red-roofed buildings adjoin the conservatory. These were the quarters for a limited number of servants needed at the Mansion. Comfortable cabins to house the rest of the negroes were located at convenient distances about the plantation. Both these quarters were in ruins, but have been restored—the West Quarters by Mrs. Jennie Meeker Ward, late Vice-Regent for Kansas in 1890, and the East Quarters by Miss Amy Townsend, late Vice-Regent for New York in 1897. While in exterior form these buildings are identical with their original appearance, the interior of each has been somewhat changed to meet existing requirements.

Kitchen Garden



George Washington's fondness for experimental gardening is shown by the care with which he arranged these terraced beds for growing small fruits and vegetables for the use of his household. His diary is evidence enough of the eagerness with which he selected the best-known seed and exploited, with more or less success, the latest improvements in horticulture.

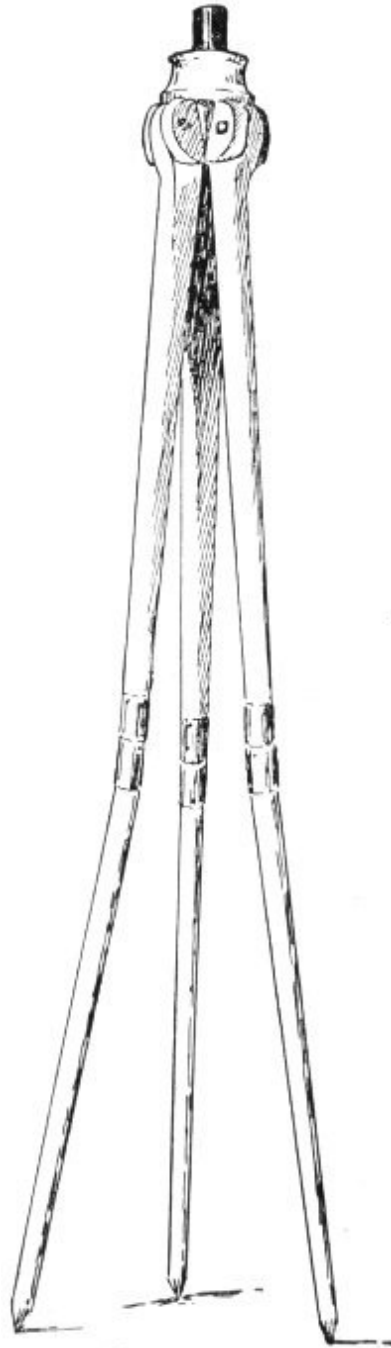
Sheltered by the walls he built, scions of original fig bushes still flourish, while bordering the cross walk to the gate, the box hedge he planted has developed to unusual proportions.



Compass

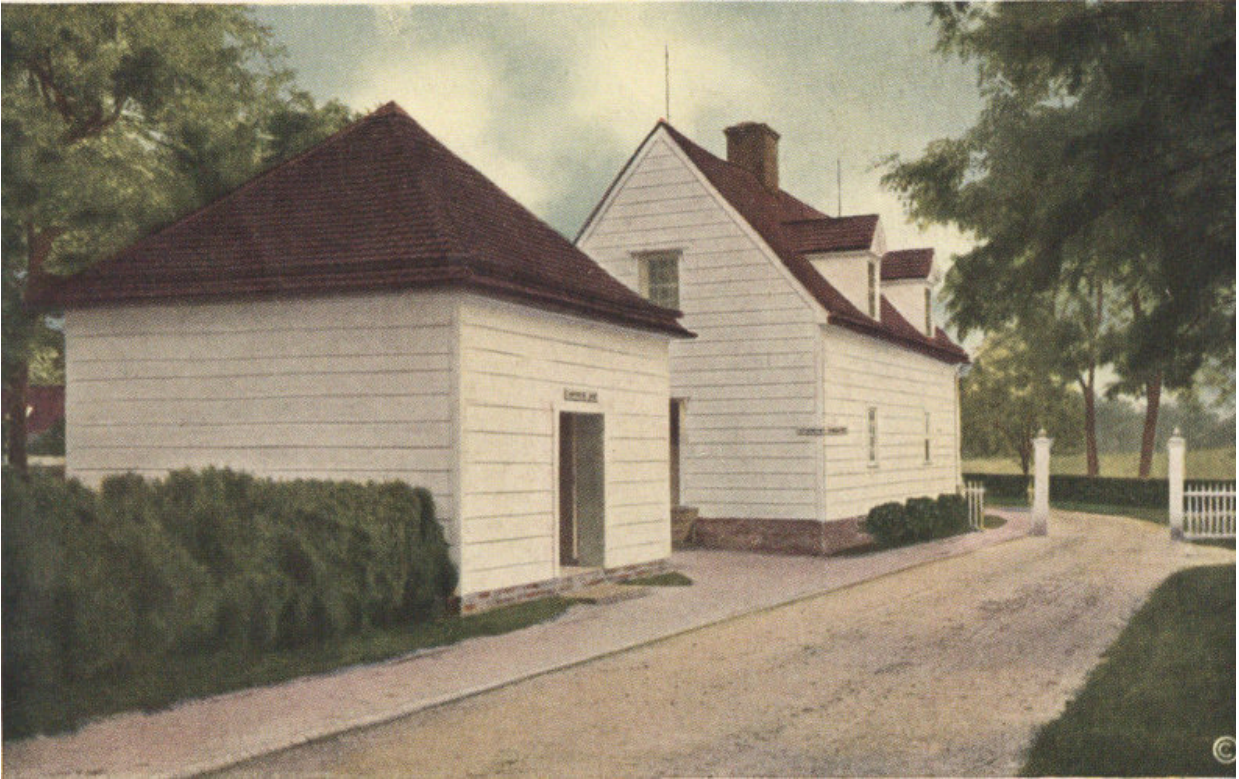


Spy Glass



Tripod

The Carpenter Shop



In Washington's day this building was the center of much activity, it being the all-essential tool-shop for general repairs.

In outward appearance its original character and purpose are still preserved.

Its interior arrangement, however, has been altered to meet the urgent need of a fireproof repository for valuable records of the Association.

The Spinning House

The spinning house, north of the court, is where much material was prepared for clothing the servants, and where rag carpets and other fabrics were woven for the use of the family. Flax, cotton, wool and silk were there put through the various processes of spinning and weaving by skilled servants. The old loom, wheels, reels, and flaxbrake were recovered by Mrs. Rebecca B. Flandrau, late Vice-Regent for Minnesota, 1892.

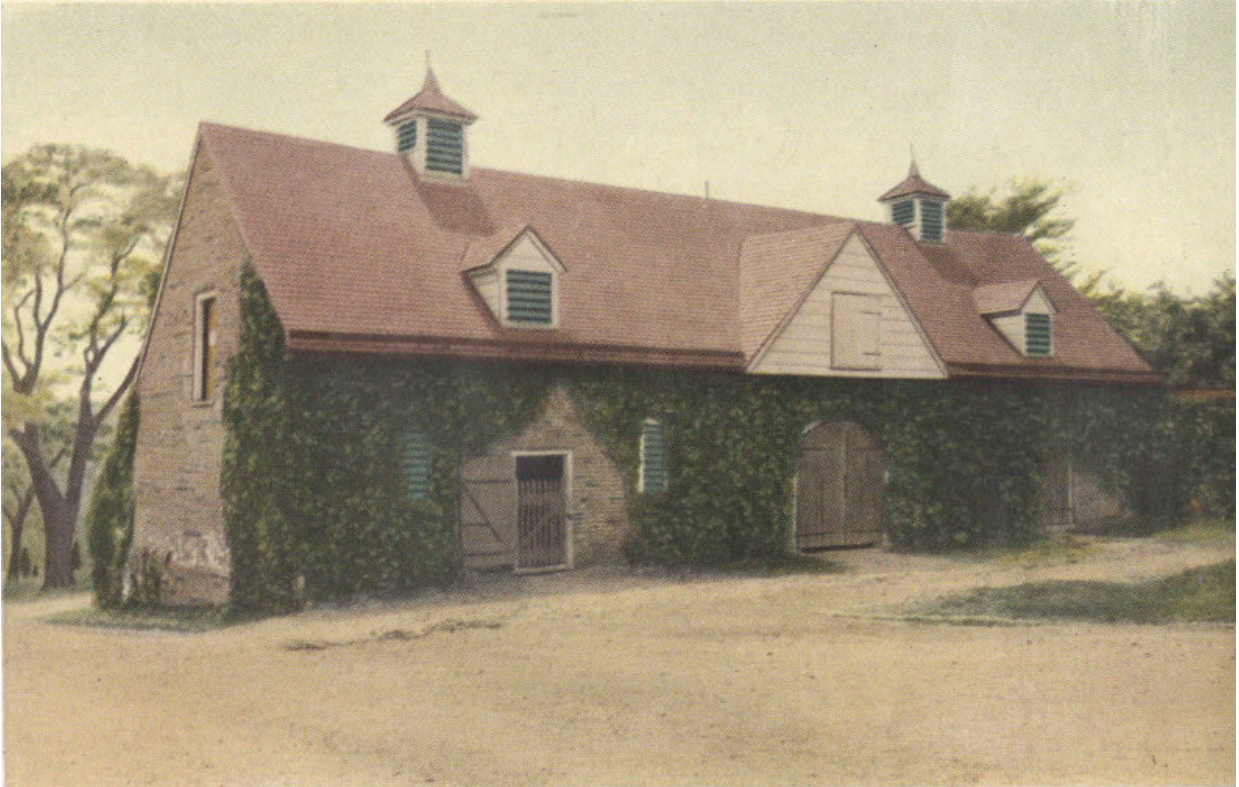


Hunting Horn



***Presented to General Washington by Agricultural Society of South
Carolina as a Premium for raising the largest Jackass
1790***

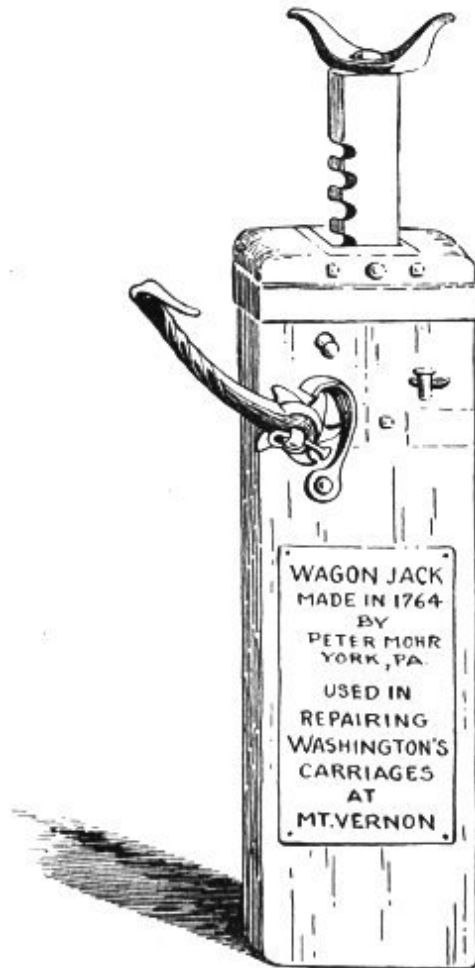
The Barn



The oldest building here is the barn, erected in 1733 by Washington's father. The bricks are said to have been brought from England, and they were laid in strong mortar made of oyster-shell lime. The shingle roof of this building was renewed in 1874, the cost being shared by all the members of the Association. Substantial renovations of the interior were effected in 1896-7 by Mrs. William Ames, the late Vice-Regent for Rhode Island.

Here were stabled the coach horses and saddle horses. Washington's famous traveling coach, the "White Chariot," as he called it, was kept in the coach house near by. This coach house was restored in 1894 by the Vice-Regent for Michigan, who was also instrumental in obtaining (1901) the ancient vehicle now here, a duplicate of the original carriage owned by Washington. From

well-founded tradition it is believed that General and Mrs. Washington frequently rode in this coach.



**WAGON JACK MADE IN 1764 BY PETER MOHR
YORK, PA.
USED IN REPAIRING WASHINGTON'S CARRIAGES AT MT.
VERNON**

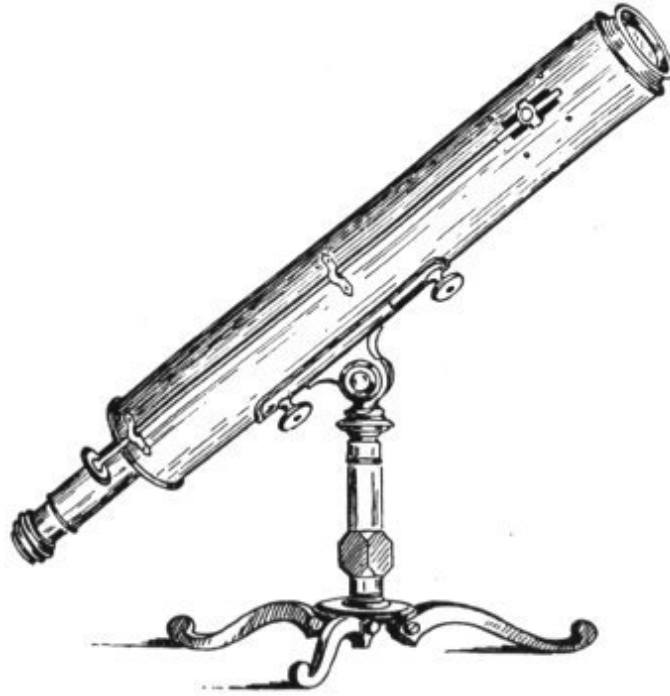
An original feature restored as Washington had it, was a “Ha Ha” wall extending from opposite the barn to the summer house, also a screen wall flanking the road from the barn to the kitchen.

Summer House



On the brow of the steep hillside, south of the Mansion, overlooking the river, is the summer house. It commands a beautiful view of the broad Potomac, with the Maryland hills beyond, and doubtless was a favorite resort in “ye olden time.” It was restored in 1886, the funds being raised by the Vice-Regent for Louisiana, Mrs. Ida A. Richardson, through the school children of her State. The deep cellar under the summer house was intended for an ice house, but it is believed to have been abandoned as such when another was constructed in a more convenient locality north of the Mansion.

The wooded slope below the summer house was utilized by Washington for his deer paddock, which was restored and stocked with Virginia deer, in 1887, by the sons of the late Mrs. Robert Campbell, Vice-Regent for Missouri.



Telescope

Mount Vernon Wharf



Washington shipped much of his farm produce and supplies by water—and today are landed at the wharf many pilgrims to the home and tomb of the “Father of His Country.” The custom of tolling a bell as a mark of respect to his memory is hallowed by its observance for more than a century.

The present covering of the wharf was provided in 1891 by Mrs. Phoebe A. Hearst, late Vice-Regent for California. The parapet for protection of the public was given by the Vice-Regent for the State of Washington, and the Iron Gates by the Vice-Regent for Oregon.

Mrs. Hearst also caused to be built the substantial stone sea-wall as a necessary protection to the wooded shore against wave-wash during storms. This important improvement has enabled the Association to complete the

filling of neighboring ravines and swamps, thus accomplishing a valuable reclamation now utilized as meadow land.

From the wharf a road and walk lead to the Tomb and Mansion.

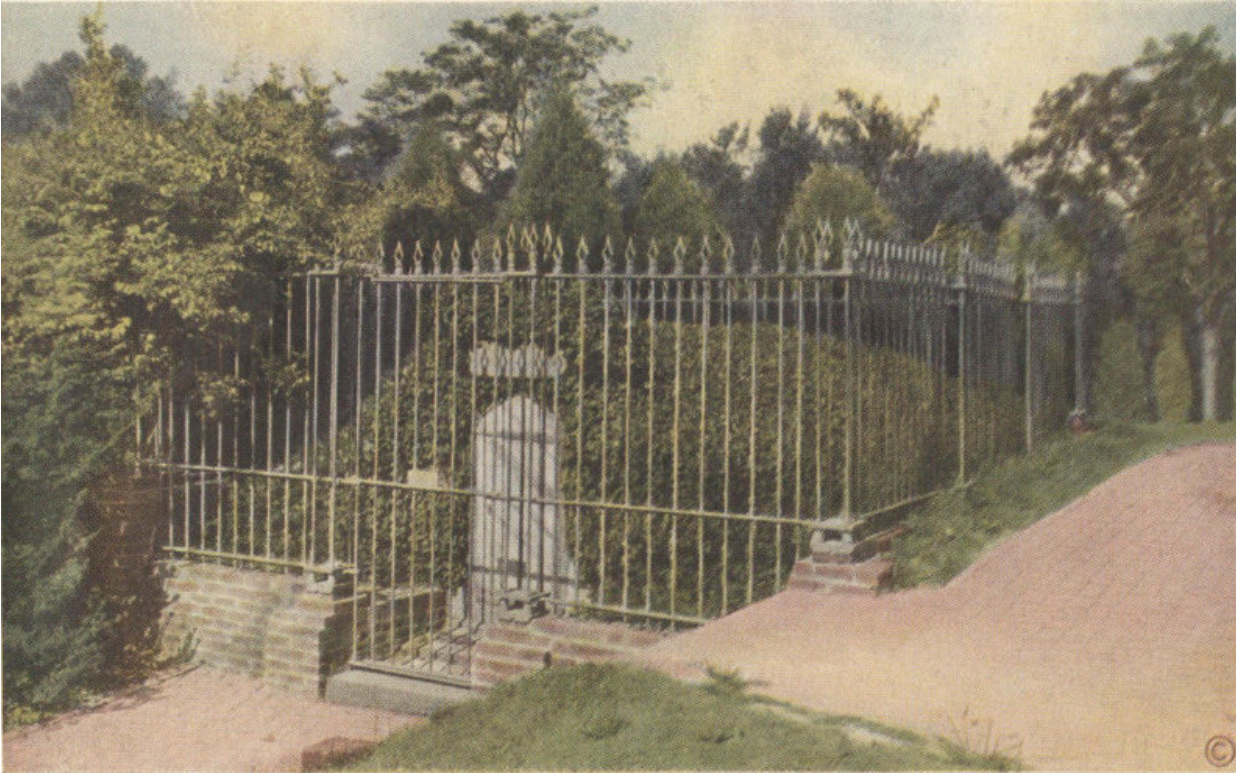


Land Barometer



Ship Barometer

Old Tomb



On the edge of the hill, midway down the road leading to the wharf, an iron-railed enclosure marks where Washington's remains rested from 1799 until 1831. This vault was constructed by George Washington, but later, believing it to be insecure, he planned another tomb, which his executors built. In April, 1831, all bodies in the old vault were transferred to the new tomb.

The cause of apprehension as to safety of the old structure, resulting in its abandonment, was the frequency of landslides near it.

Extensive repairs to the old tomb were made in 1887 by the Vice-Regent for Michigan. The iron railing was found necessary for protection.

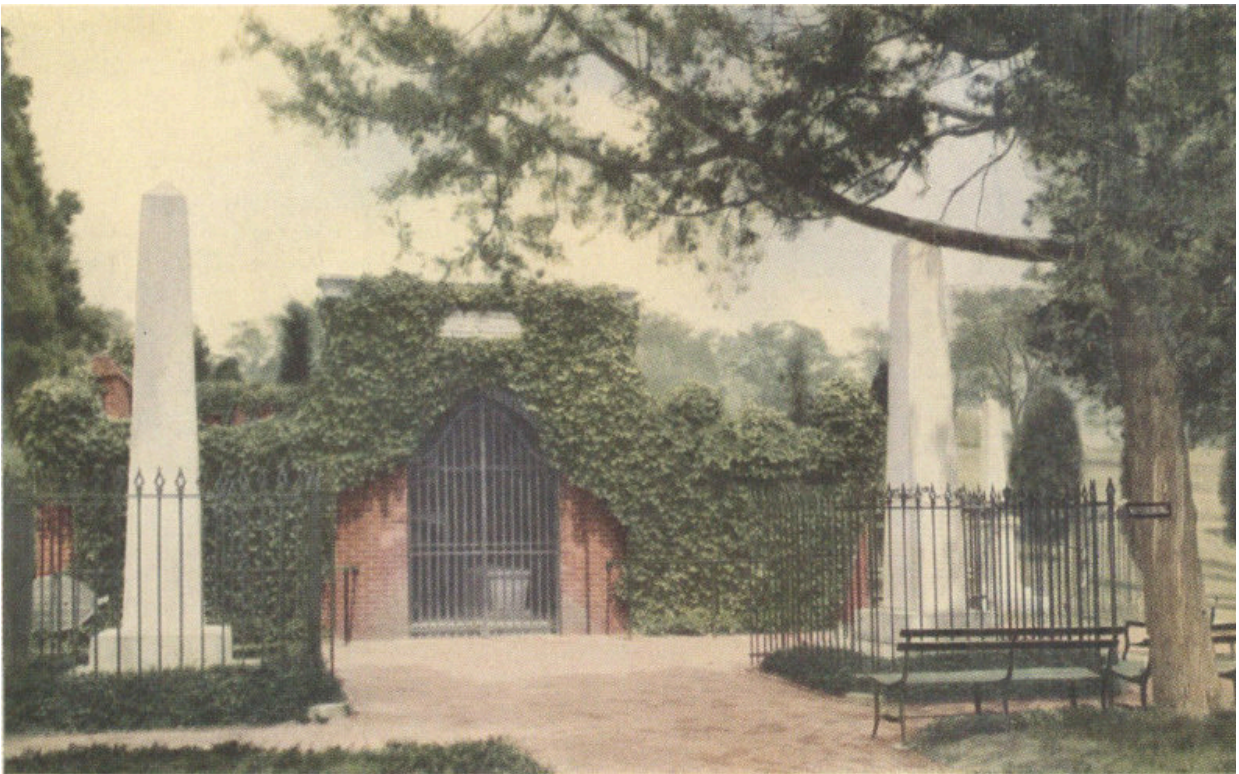
In 1908 the broad flight of brick steps was completely rebuilt, the original material, suitable for the purpose, being used again.



WASHINGTON FAMILY

New Tomb

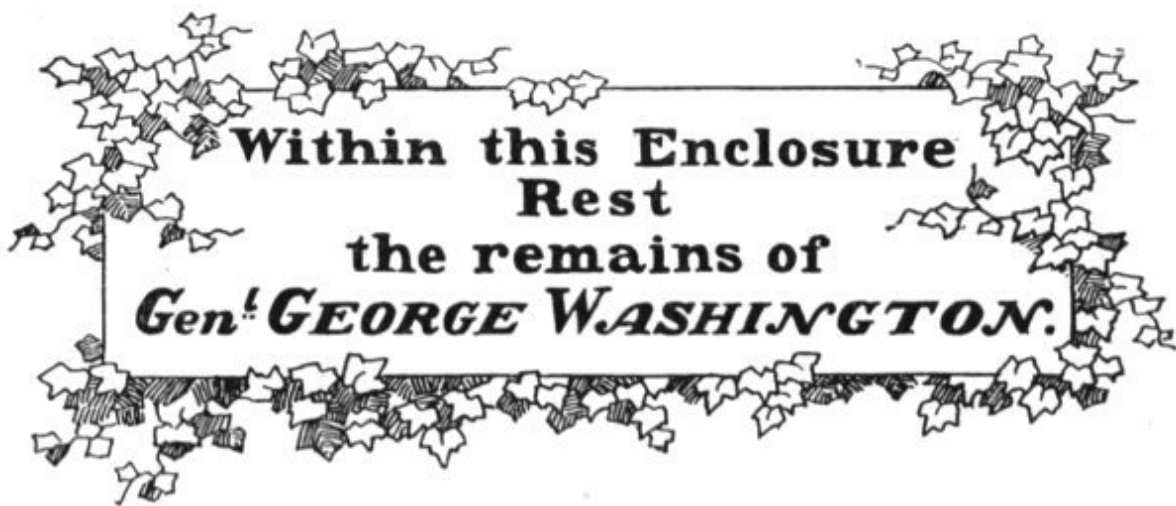
“Within this enclosure rest the remains of General George Washington.”



This plain statement empaneled above the doorway of the rigidly simple brick vault at once marks its importance. Within the doubly ironed portals may be seen two marble sarcophagi; that on the right contains the body of General Washington and the one on the left the remains of his wife. At the rear of this open vault, and connected with it through a square iron door, is an inner vault containing the remains of many of the Washington family. To the memory of Bushrod Washington and John Augustine Washington, successors of the General (whose bodies are within the vault), marble shafts

were erected in front of the tomb, while to the east are the graves of Nellie Custis and her daughter.

Washington selected this site for the vault only a few months before he died. His executors carried out his explicit directions as to construction, which accounts for its extreme simplicity. Because of Washington's distaste for display, the character of this tomb should never be changed. Extensive repairs for the preservation of the original structure were made by the Association in 1886. To this hallowed spot come pilgrims from every land.



Within this Enclosure Rest the remains of ^lGen GEORGE WASHINGTON.

***The Regents and Vice-Regents of the Mount Vernon
Ladies' Association of the Union Since its
Organization, with Dates of Appointment***

**MISS ANN PAMELA CUNNINGHAM, *Regent*,
1853-1873**

(Resigned, 1873; Died, May 1, 1875)

Vice-Regents

1858	1 MRS. ANNA CORA OGDEN	resigned	1866 Virginia
—	RITCHIE		
	2 MRS. ALICE H. DICKINSON	resigned	1859 North Carolina
	3 MRS. PHILOCLEA EDGEWORTH	died	1889 Georgia
	EVE		
	4 MRS. OCTAVIA WALTON	died	1877 Alabama
	LEVERT		
	5 MRS. CATHARINE A.	died	1872 Mississippi
	MCWILLIE		
	6 MRS. MARGARETTA S. MORSE	resigned	1872 Louisiana
	7 MRS. MARY RUTLEDGE FOGG	died	1872 Tennessee
	8 MRS. ELIZABETH M. WALTON	resigned	1858 Missouri
	9 MISS MARY MORRIS	resigned	1866 New York
	HAMILTON		
	10 MRS. LOUISA INGERSOLL	resigned	1865 Massachusetts
	GREENOUGH		
	11 MRS. ABBA ISABELLA LITTLE	resigned	1866 Maine
	12 MRS. CATHERINE WILLIS	died	1867 Florida
	MURAT		
	13 MRS. MARY BOOTH GOODRICH	resigned	1864 Connecticut

	14 MISS PHŒBE ANN OGDEN	died	1867 New Jersey
	15 MRS. ALICE KEY PENDLETON	resigned	1863
		died	1885 Ohio
	16 MRS. ABBY WHEATON CHACE	died	1892 Rhode Island
	17 MRS. JANE MARIA VAN ANTWERP	died	1870 Iowa
	18 MRS. MARGARET ANN COMEGYS	died	1888 Delaware
	19 MRS. HANNAH BLAKE FARNSWORTH	died	1879 Michigan
	20 MRS. SARAH KING HALE	resigned	1861 New Hampshire
	21 MRS. MARTHA MITCHELL	died	1902 Wisconsin
	22 MRS. ROSA VERTNER JOHNSON JEFFRIES	died	1894 Kentucky
	MRS. JANET M. C. RIGGS, <i>Acting Vice-Regent</i>		District of Columbia
1859 —	23 MRS. ELIZABETH WILLARD BARRY	died	1883 Illinois
	24 MRS. SARAH J. SIBLEY	died	1869 Minnesota
	25 MRS. MARY PEPPERELL JARVIS CUTTS	resigned	1878 Vermont
	26 MISS LILY LYTLÉ MACALESTER	died	1891 Pennsylvania
	27 MRS. MAGDALEN G. BLANDING	resigned	1884 California
	28 MRS. HARRIET B. FITCH	died	1880 Indiana
	29 MRS. SARAH H. JOHNSON	died	1866 Arkansas
	30 MRS. LETITIA HARPER WALKER	died	1908 North Carolina
1860 —	31 MRS. ANN LUCAS HUNT	died	1878 Missouri
	32 MRS. MARY CHESNUT	died	1867 South Carolina
1866 —	33 MRS. MARGARET J. M. SWEAT	died	1908 Maine
	34 MISS EMILY L. HARPER	died	1891 Maryland

	35 MRS. LUCY H. PICKENS	died	1899 North Carolina
	36 MRS. M. E. HICKMAN	resigned	1874 Nevada
	37 MRS. M. A. STEARNS	resigned	1873 New Hampshire
	38 MRS. EMILY R. M. HEWSON	resigned	1872 Ohio
	39 MISS ELLA HUTCHINS	resigned	1872 Texas
1867	40 MRS. JANET M. C. RIGGS	resigned	1868
—		died	1871 District of Columbia
	41 MRS. MARIA BROOKS	resigned	1876 New York
	42 MRS. MATILDA W. EMORY	resigned	1873 District of Columbia
1868	43 MRS. NANCY WADE HALSTED	died	1891 New Jersey
—			
	44 MRS. NANNIE C. YULEE	died	1884 Florida
1870	45 MRS. SUSAN E. JOHNSON	died	1913 Connecticut
—	HUDSON		
	46 MRS. ELLA BASSETT	died	1898 West Virginia
	WASHINGTON		
1872	47 MRS. BETSY C. MASON	died	1873 Virginia
—			
	48 MRS. A. P. DILLON	resigned	1873
		died	1898 Iowa
	49 MRS. C. L. SCOTT	resigned	1878 Arkansas
1873	50 MRS. WILLIAM BALFOUR	resigned	1875 Mississippi
—			
	51 MRS. MARY T. BARNES	died	1912 District of Columbia
	52 MRS. DAVID URQUEHART	resigned	1876 Louisiana
	53 MISS M. E. MAVERICK	resigned	1873 Texas

MRS. LILY LYTLÉ MACALESTER

BERGHMAN, *Second Regent*

(Made Acting Regent, 1873; Regent, June, 1874; Died, 1891)

1874	54 MRS. EMMA READ BALL	died	1918 Virginia
—	55 MRS. AARON V. BROWN	died	1889 Tennessee
1875	56 MRS. ELIZABETH LYTLE	died	1890 Ohio
—	BROADWELL		
	57 MRS. JOHN P. JONES	resigned	1876 Nevada
1876	58 MRS. JENNIE MEEKER WARD	died	1910 Kansas
—	59 MRS. JUSTINE VAN RENSSELAER	died	1912 New York
	TOWNSEND		
1878	60 MRS. J. GREGORY SMITH	resigned	1884 Vermont
—	61 MISS ALICE M. LONGFELLOW		Massachusetts
—	62 MRS. ROBERT CAMPBELL	died	1882 Missouri
1880	63 MRS. IDA A. RICHARDSON	died	1910 Louisiana
—	64 MRS. ELLA S. HERBERT	died	1884 Alabama
—			

Vice-Regents

1885	65 MRS. ELIZABETH B. ADAMS	resigned	1919
—	RATHBONE		
	66 MRS. MARY T. LEITER	died	1923 Michigan
	67 MRS. JANET DE KAY KING	died	1913 Illinois
	68 MRS. ELIZABETH WOODWARD	died	1896 Vermont
	69 MISS HARRIET CLAYTON	Elected	1987 Kentucky
1888	COMEYGS	Regent	1909 Delaware
—	70 MRS. FANNIE GILCHRIST	died	1901 Florida
	BAKER		
1889	71 MRS. ALICE HILL	died	1908 Colorado
—	72 MRS. REBECCA B. FLANDRAU	died	1912 Minnesota

	73 MRS. PHOEBE A. HEARST	died	1919 California
1890	74 MRS. A. R. WINDER	died	1906 New Hampshire
1891	75 MRS. GEORGIA PAGE WILDER	died	1914 Georgia

MRS. JUSTINE VAN RENSSELAER TOWNSEND, *Third Regent*

(Elected Temporary Regent, December, 1891; Regent, June, 1892; Died, 1912)

1893	76 MRS. GEO. R. GOLDSBOROUGH	resigned	1904
		died	1906 Maryland
	77 MRS. J. DUNDAS LIPPINCOTT	died	1894 Pennsylvania
	78 MISS MARY LLOYD PENDLETON	resigned	1897 Ohio
	79 MRS. PHILIP SCHUYLER	resigned	1894 New York
	80 MRS. CHRISTINE BLAIR GRAHAM	died	1915 Missouri
	81 MRS. FRANCIS STEVENS CONOVER	died	1914 New Jersey
	82 MRS. MARY POLK YEATMAN WEBB	died	1917 Tennessee
1894	83 MISS LELIA HERBERT	died	1897 Alabama
1895	84 MRS. ROBERT H. CLARKSON	resigned	1900
		died	1902 Nebraska
	85 MRS. WILLIAM AMES	died	1904 Rhode Island
	86 MISS AMY TOWNSEND	died	1920 New York
1896	87 MRS. CHARLES CUSTIS HARRISON	died	1922 Pennsylvania
	88 MRS. THOMAS S. MAXEY		Texas

1897	89 MRS. JAMES E. CAMPBELL	resigned	1902 Ohio
—			
1900	90 MRS. ROBERT D. JOHNSTON		Alabama
—			
	91 MRS. CHARLES F. MANDERSON	died	1916 Nebraska
	92 MRS. EUGENE VAN RENSSELAER	died	1924 West Virginia
1901	93 MRS. JOHN JULIUS PRINGLE	died	1921 South Carolina
—			
	94 MRS. WILLIAM F. BARRET	died	1920 Kentucky
	95 MRS. CHARLES DENBY	died	1906 Indiana
1905	96 MRS. HENRY W. ROGERS		Maryland
—			
1907	97 MRS. LEWIS IRWIN	died	1916 Ohio
—			
	98 MISS MARY F. FAILING		Oregon
	99 MRS. ELIZA FERRY LEARY		Washington
	100 MRS. FRANCES JONES RICKS	resigned	1914 Mississippi
	101 MRS. J. CARTER BROWN		Rhode Island
1909	102 MRS. A. B. ANDREWS	died	1915 North Carolina
—			

MISS HARRIET CLAYTON COMEGYS, *Fourth* Regent

(Elected, May, 1909; Resigned, May, 1927; Died, August, 1927)

1911	103 MRS. ALICE H. RICHARDS		Maine
—			
	104 MISS MARY EVARTS	resigned	1923 Vermont
	105 MRS. ANTOINE LENTILHON FOSTER		Delaware
1912	106 MISS ANNIE RAGAN KING		Louisiana
—			
	107 MISS JANE A. RIGGS		District of Columbia

1913	108	MRS. HORACE MANN TOWNER		Iowa
	109	MRS. THOMAS PALMER DENHAM		Florida
1914	110	MISS HARRIET L. HUNTRESS	died	1922 New Hampshire
	111	MRS. CHARLES ELIOT FURNESS		Minnesota
	112	MRS. BENJAMIN D. WALCOTT		Indiana
	113	MRS. LUCIEN M. HANKS		Wisconsin
1915	114	MISS ANNIE BURR JENNINGS		Connecticut
	115	MRS. WILLARD HALL BRADFORD		New Jersey
1916	116	MRS. CHARLES NAGEL		Missouri
	117	MRS. GEORGE A. CARPENTER		Illinois
	118	MISS MARY GOVAN BILLUPS		Mississippi
	119	MRS. JOHN V. ABRAHAMS	resigned	1921 Kansas
1919	120	MRS. WILLIAM EWEN SHIPP		North Carolina
	121	MRS. HORTON POPE		Colorado
	122	MRS. CHARLES J. LIVINGOOD		Ohio
	123	MRS. JEFFERSON RANDOLPH ANDERSON		Georgia
	124	MRS. CELSUS PRICE PERRIE	resigned	1922 Arkansas
1920	125	MRS. HORACE VAN DEVENTER		Tennessee
	126	MRS. CHARLES STETSON WHEELER		California
1921	127	MRS. WILLIAM RUFFIN COX	died	1925 Virginia
1922	128	MRS. HENRY GOLD DANFORTH		New York

1923	129	MISS MARY MASON SCOTT		Kentucky
	130	MRS. ALEXANDER C. TROUP		Nebraska
	131	MRS. JOHN REYNOLDS SHELTON		Kansas
	132	MRS. EDWARD H. PARKER	died	1924 Michigan
1924	133	MISS MARY EVARTS		Vermont
1924	134	MISS VIRGINIA LEIGH PORCHER		South Carolina
	135	MRS. WILLIAM R. MERCER	resigned	1928 Pennsylvania
	136	MISS CONSTANCE LEE PETERKIN		West Virginia
1925	137	MRS. BENJAMIN S. WARREN		Michigan
1927	138	MRS. FAIRFAX HARRISON		Virginia

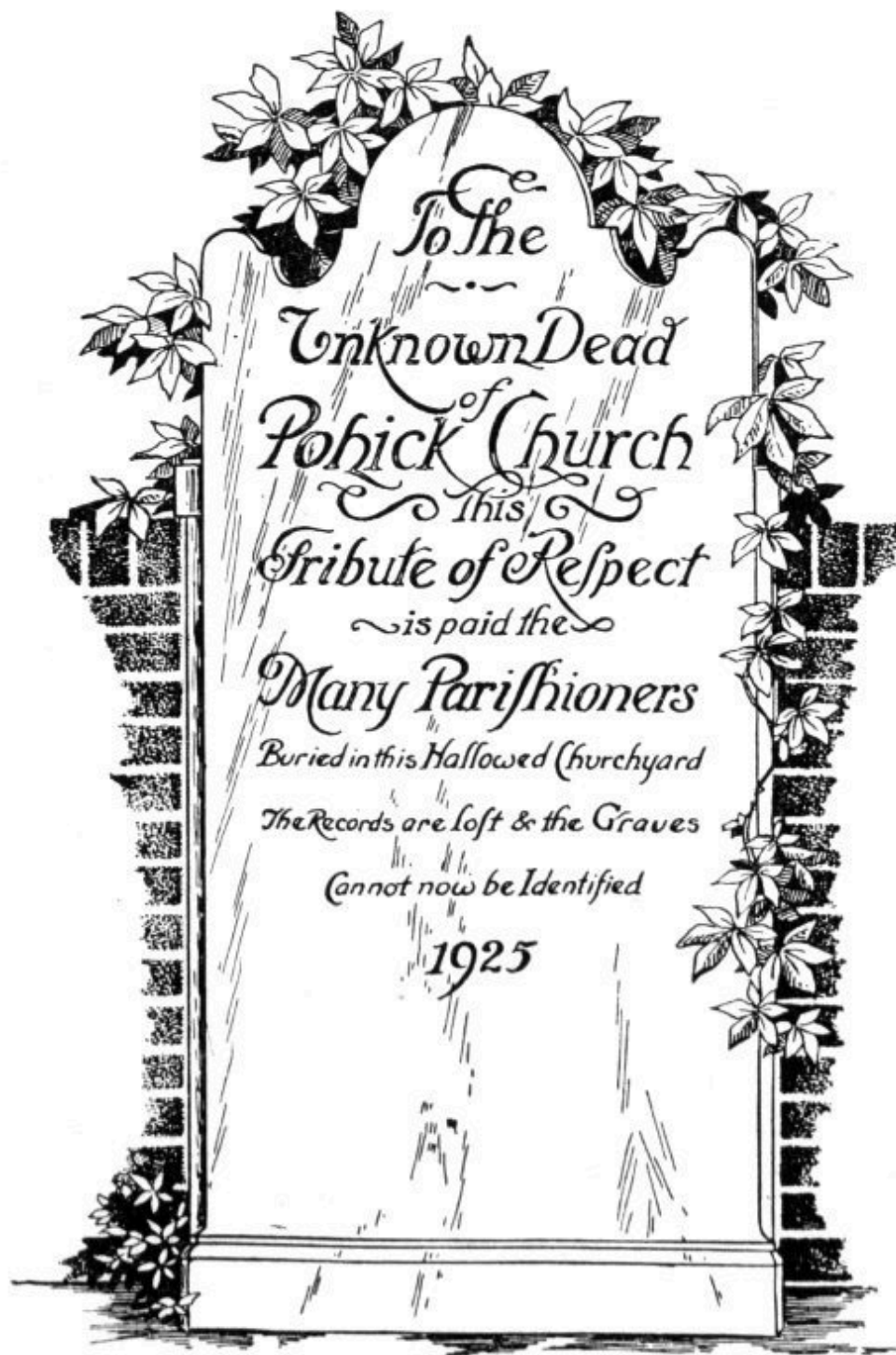
MRS. ALICE H. RICHARDS, *Fifth Regent*
(Elected, May, 1927)

Pohick Church



The parish church of Mount Vernon, six miles distant from the Mansion, was built during the years 1768-70 from the plans drawn by General Washington, who was a member of the building committee. He was a vestryman of the parish for twenty years, and for the greater part of that time was a regular attendant at service, never permitting, as Bishop Meade says, “the weather or company to keep him from church.” Subsequently Washington became connected with Christ Church, Alexandria, where today his family pew may be seen as he used it.

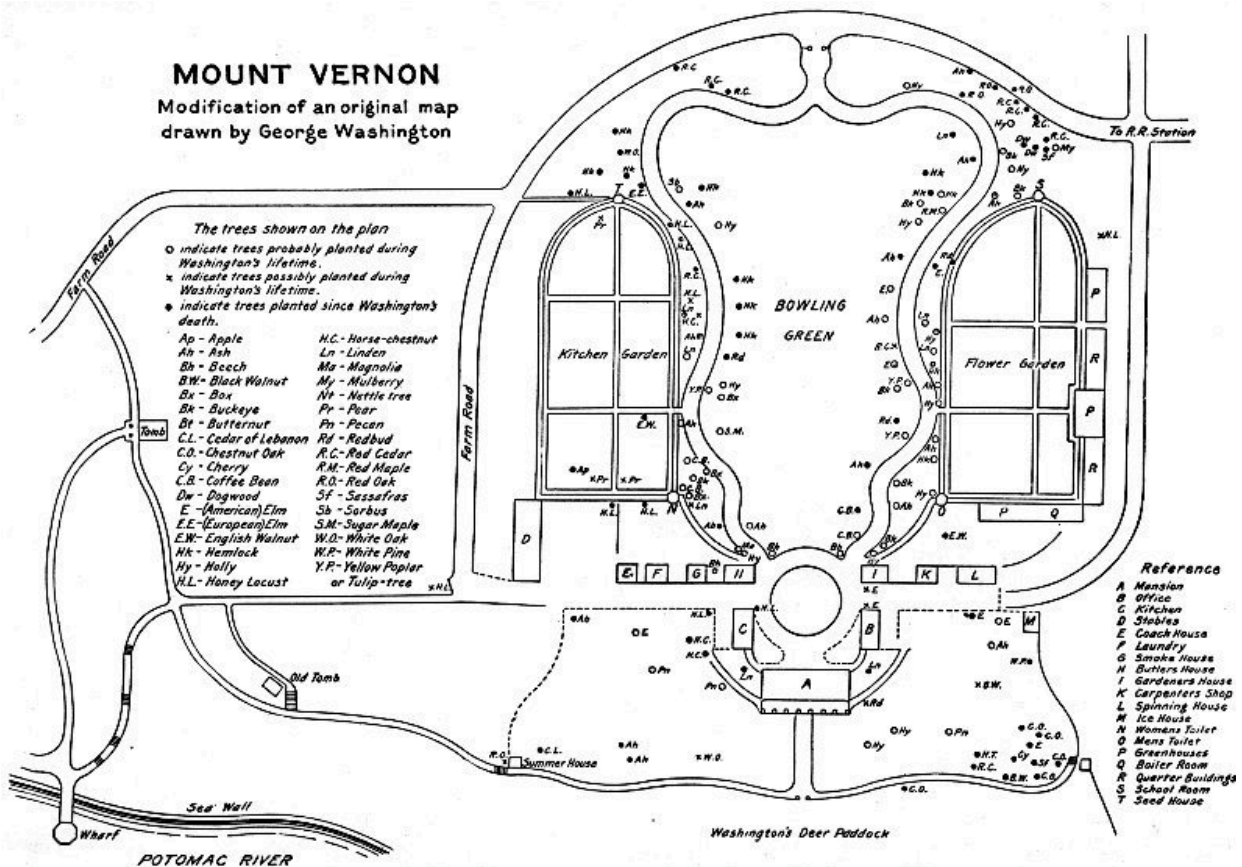
Pohick Church, during the Civil War, was occupied at times by Federal troops and all the interior furnishings were destroyed. The late Vice-Regent for Michigan, Mrs. E. B. A. Rathbone, worked untiringly in the interest of the church, and to her are due the large additions to its endowment fund. Through the efforts of Miss Amy Townsend, former Vice-Regent for New York, both interior and exterior have been faithfully restored to their original appearance at the time of Washington.



**To The
Unknown Dead
of
Pohick Church**

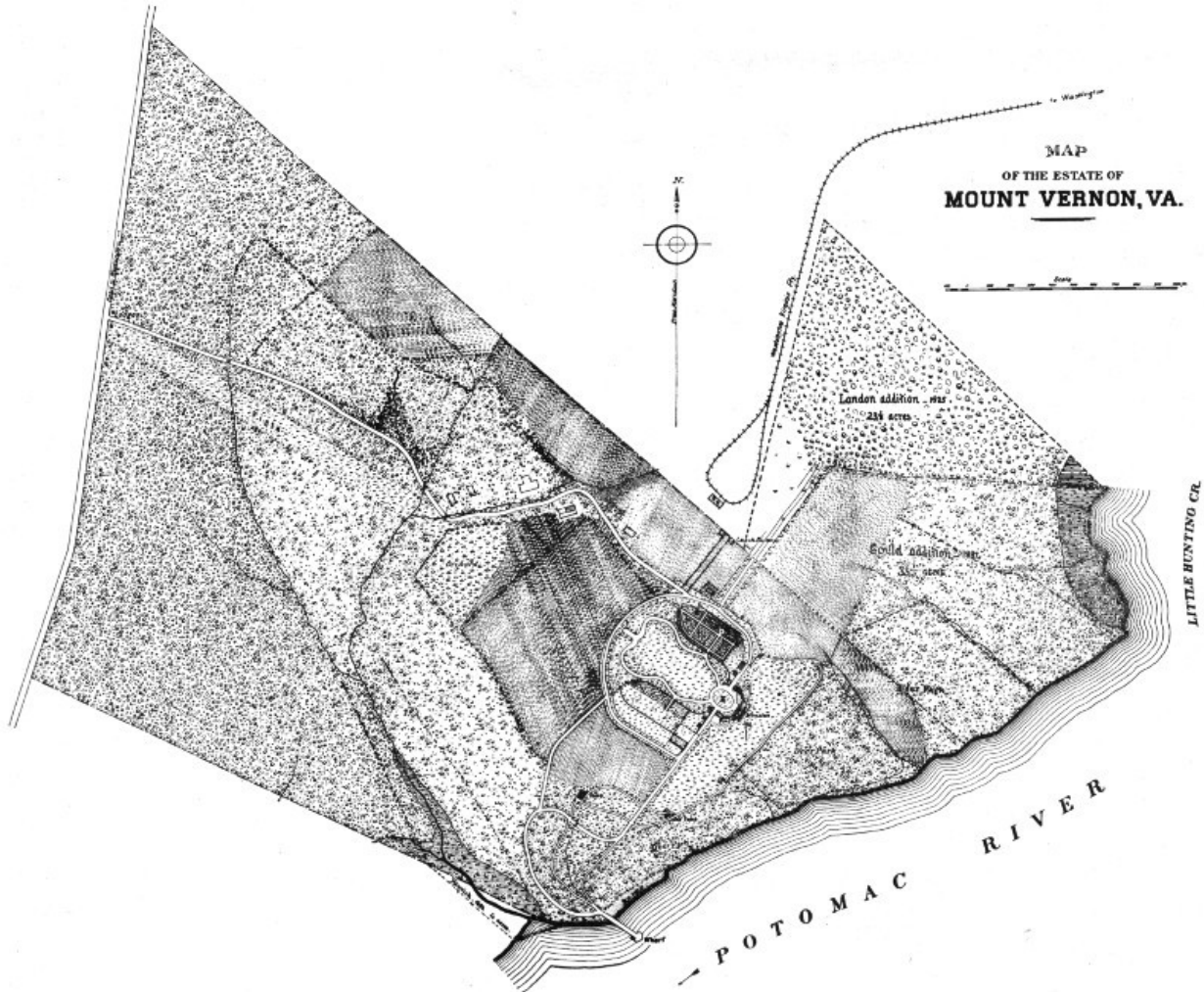
This
Tribute of Respect
 is paid the
Many Parishioners
 Buried in this Hallowed Churchyard
 The Records are Lost & the Graves
 Cannot now be Identified
1925

35



MOUNT VERNON
 Modification of an original map drawn by George Washington

[High-resolution Map](#)



MAP OF THE ESTATE OF MOUNT VERNON, VA.
Photographed, Engraved and Printed by The Beck Engraving Co.,
Phila.

[High-resolution Map](#)

Transcriber's Notes

- Retained publication information from the printed edition: this eBook is public-domain in the country of publication.
- Corrected a few palpable typos.
- In the text versions only, text in italics is delimited by `_underscores_`.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AN ILLUSTRATED
HANDBOOK OF MOUNT VERNON, THE HOME OF WASHINGTON

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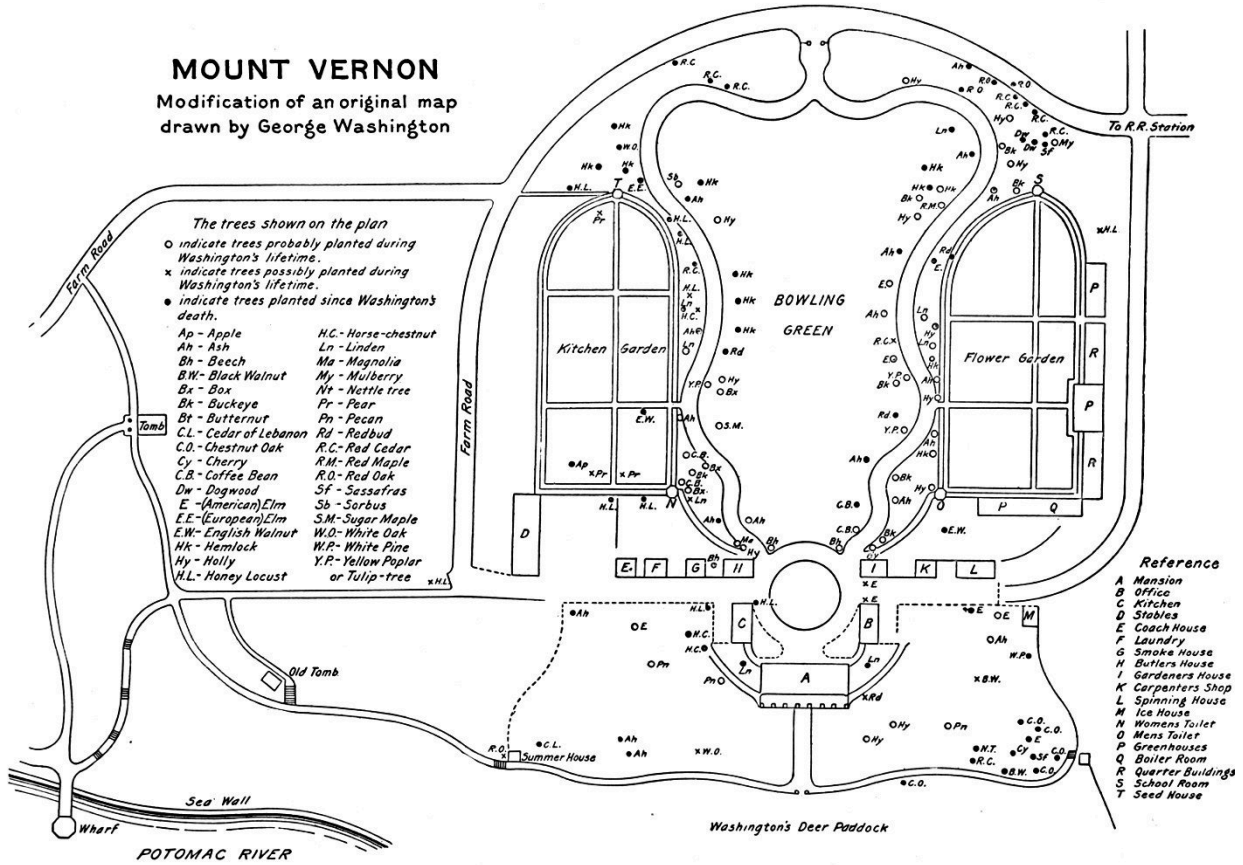
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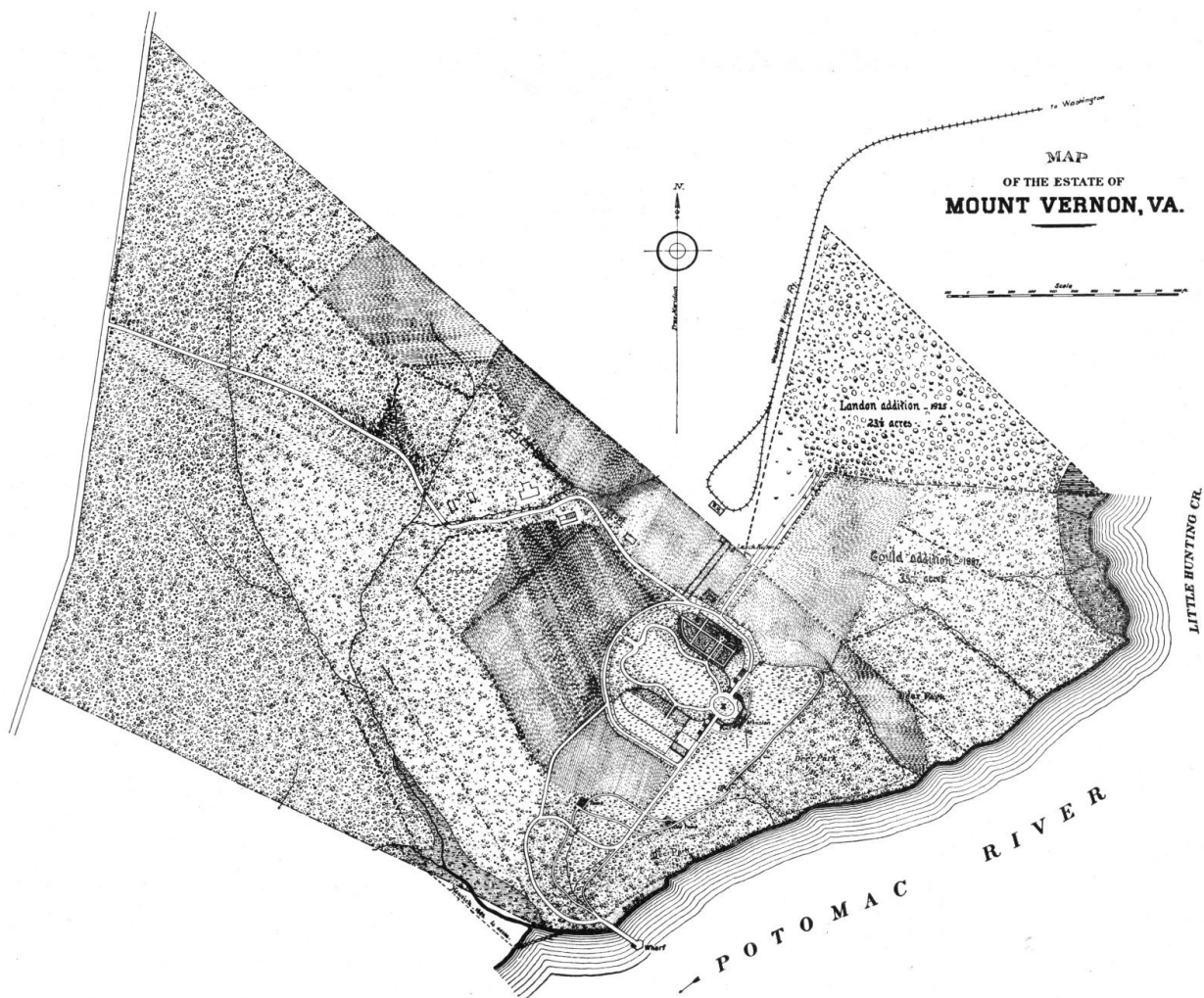
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